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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Programme planning

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part V

Regional cooperation for development

Section 18

Economic and social development in Africa

Programme 15

Economic and social development in Africa

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* The present document (A/81/6 (Sect. 18)/Part A), consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II; see General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), para. 10), will be replaced by a document containing parts A and B (A/81/6 (Sect. 18)) once part B is issued.

** [A/81/50](#).

*** In keeping with paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), the part consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II) is submitted through the Committee for Programme and Coordination for the consideration of the Assembly.



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I. Economic Commission for Africa

A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025

Overall orientation

Mandates and background

- 18.1 The Economic Commission for Africa (ECA) is responsible for promoting the economic and social development of its members, fostering intraregional integration and promoting international cooperation for the development of Africa. The mandate derives from the priorities established in relevant General Assembly resolutions and decisions, and Economic and Social Council resolution [671 A \(XXV\)](#).
- 18.2 ECA provides innovative solutions, together with demand-driven and tailor-made policy and technical advice, grounded in evidence, to its members and regional economic communities to strengthen their social and economic resilience and achieve the goals of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and Agenda 2063: The Africa We Want, of the African Union. ECA is well positioned to support member States, within its mandate, in the implementation of relevant commitments and actions outlined in the Pact for the Future (General Assembly resolution [79/1](#)). ECA also works to build the capacity of its members to formulate and implement policies for sustainable development, including through the implementation of the regular programme for technical cooperation and Development Account projects.

Strategy and external factors for 2027

- 18.3 In 2027, ECA will concentrate on five strategic directions:
 - (a) Deploying knowledge to support policymaking to drive the development agenda of Africa and foster infrastructure development, including in the areas of energy; technology, innovation and connectivity; and climate action and food security;
 - (b) Formulating policy options, including macroeconomic policies, to accelerate sustainable industrialization and economic diversification;
 - (c) Enhancing the mainstreaming of data and statistics, designing and implementing financing models and leveraging them for the development of human, physical and social infrastructure assets;
 - (d) Supporting deeper regional integration and the development of regional public goods, focusing on social inclusion and considering synergies between the economic and social development programmes of Africa;
 - (e) Advocating a common position for Africa at the global level and developing regional responses as a contribution to global governance issues.
- 18.4 Within its existing mandate, and in line with the actions and decisions contained in the Pact for the Future and the commitments contained in the Global Digital Compact and the Declaration on Future Generations, ECA will pay particular attention to supporting member States in leveraging technology and artificial intelligence for economic and social development and promoting digital cooperation, as well as further developing sustainable regional value chains for economic diversification, harnessing the demographic dividend and increasing engagement with young people in the design of policies and programmes.
- 18.5 In pursuing these strategic directions, ECA will employ its convening function, through the provision of multilateral and multi-stakeholder platforms such as the Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable

Development, the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development, and the subregional intergovernmental committees of experts and senior officials; its think tank function, by conducting interdisciplinary research and the analysis of key challenges facing its members and Africa as a whole, while promoting peer learning and development; and its operational function, through the provision of tailor-made policy and technical advice to its members, including in cooperation with other entities of the United Nations system. In line with action 45 (a) of the Pact for the Future, ECA will further strengthen its institutional capabilities to better support member States in delivering on its mandates. The work of ECA will additionally be anchored in other multilateral frameworks such as the Paris Agreement, the Sevilla Commitment of the Fourth International Conference on Financing for Development and the Doha Political Declaration of the World Social Summit.

- 18.6 With a view to enabling a sharper focus on priorities for the continent and to better reflect mandates entrusted to ECA by the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development, subprogramme 6 has been renamed “Economic empowerment of women and youth” to reflect the support provided by the subprogramme on issues related to young people. In addition, subprogramme 9 has been renamed “Poverty and socioeconomic policy” to better reflect the focus of the subprogramme’s work. These changes were endorsed by the Conference of African Ministers in its report (E/ECA/COE/44/23).
- 18.7 With regard to cooperation with other entities, ECA will continue its close cooperation with the African Union Commission and will build upon its existing strategic partnerships with regional and subregional organizations, central banks, universities, think tanks and civil society and private sector organizations and forge new partnerships towards the fulfilment of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063. Regarding South-South and triangular cooperation, ECA will leverage partnerships premised on the principle of enhancing complementarity and impact.
- 18.8 With regard to inter-agency coordination and liaison, ECA, as Co-Chair, will continue to work through the Regional Collaborative Platform for Africa and its opportunity and issue-based coalitions, and will enhance collaboration with regional United Nations entities, the Department of Economic and Social Affairs and the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD). At the country level, ECA will work closely with resident coordinators and country teams on projects to respond to country demands.
- 18.9 With regard to the external factors, the overall plan for 2027 is based on the following planning assumptions:
 - (a) Members of ECA and regional economic communities will actively engage with the recommended policies, models, tools, norms and standards of ECA, prioritizing their adoption and integration, and will continue to cooperate among and between themselves for harmonized action towards the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063;
 - (b) The Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable Development, the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development, and the subregional intergovernmental committees of experts and senior officials continue to provide policy advice to ECA on emerging priorities.
- 18.10 ECA integrates a gender perspective in its operational activities, deliverables and results, as appropriate, by promoting further alignment and coherence between global, regional and national frameworks on gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls. Moreover, subprogramme 6 will continue to support members of ECA in achieving Sustainable Development Goal 5 and will provide technical support to the Commission’s other subprogrammes to integrate a gender perspective into their work.
- 18.11 In line with the United Nations Disability Inclusion Strategy, ECA will pursue the implementation of measures to ensure the inclusion of persons with disabilities in its operational activities, programmes and projects, as appropriate, including the provision of reasonable accommodation for conference and workshop participants.

Adjustments arising from the UN80 Initiative

- 18.12 The proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative. For example, the urbanization workstream, previously under subprogramme 9, has been integrated into subprogramme 1, as reflected in the updated strategies and deliverables of both subprogrammes.
- 18.13 ECA will be guided by any future decisions taken in the context of the UN80 Initiative, in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures, including decisions, resolutions and established practice of the competent intergovernmental organs. This includes, among others, any decisions concerning proposals for strengthening collaboration with UNCTAD, the Department of Economic and Social Affairs and the other regional commissions through joint mechanisms. ECA will jointly explore options for strengthening macroeconomic analysis capacities, with a view to contributing more harmonized analysis and policy support to Member States. ECA will also consider proposals aimed at streamlining support for the least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States and strengthening and optimizing organizational arrangements in this regard, as appropriate.

Legislative mandates

- 18.14 The list below, which was reviewed in preparation of the proposed programme budget, provides all mandates entrusted to the programme.

General Assembly resolutions

57/2	United Nations Declaration on the New Partnership for Africa's Development	79/201	Entrepreneurship for sustainable development
61/234	Enhancing the role of the subregional offices of the Economic Commission for Africa	79/202	Promoting sustainable consumption and production patterns for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, building on Agenda 21
69/313	Addis Ababa Action Agenda of the Third International Conference on Financing for Development (Addis Ababa Action Agenda)	79/203	Follow-up to and implementation of the SIDS Accelerated Modalities of Action (SAMOA) Pathway and the Mauritius Strategy for the Further Implementation of the Programme of Action for the Sustainable Development of Small Island Developing States
70/1	Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development		
76/258	Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries		
76/298	Implementation of the recommendations contained in the report of the Secretary-General on the causes of conflict and the promotion of durable peace and sustainable development in Africa	79/215	Towards a New International Economic Order
		79/216	Role of the United Nations in promoting development in the context of globalization and interdependence
77/334	Follow-up to the United Nations Conference on the Midterm Comprehensive Review of the Implementation of the Objectives of the International Decade for Action, "Water for Sustainable Development", 2018–2028	79/217	International migration and development
		79/220	Promotion of sustainable and resilient tourism, including ecotourism, for poverty eradication and environmental protection
78/1	Political declaration of the high-level political forum on sustainable development convened under the auspices of the General Assembly	79/222	Industrial development cooperation
		79/223	Women in development
		79/226	Quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system
78/139	Financial inclusion for sustainable development		
79/1	The Pact for the Future	79/228	Towards global partnerships: a principle-based approach to enhance cooperation between the United Nations and all relevant partners
79/149	Inclusive development for and with persons with disabilities		
79/178	Human rights and extreme poverty		

Part V	Regional cooperation for development		
79/233	Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034	80/138	Protection of global climate for present and future generations of humankind
79/263	New Partnership for Africa’s Development: progress in implementation and international support	80/142	Ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all
79/323	Sevilla Commitment	80/149	Development cooperation with middle-income countries
79/329	Cooperation between the United Nations and the African Union	80/150	Follow-up to the Fifth United Nations Conference on the Least Developed Countries
80/5	Doha Political Declaration of the “World Social Summit” under the title “the Second World Summit for Social Development”	80/151	Follow-up to the Third United Nations Conference on Landlocked Developing Countries
80/118	Information and communications technologies for sustainable development	80/153	Implementation of the Third United Nations Decade for the Eradication of Poverty (2018–2027)
80/121	International trade and development	80/154	Eradicating rural poverty to implement the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
80/122	International financial system and development		
80/123	External debt sustainability and development	80/156	South-South cooperation
80/127	Promoting investments for sustainable development	80/178	Implementation of the outcome of the World Summit for Social Development and of the twenty-fourth special session of the General Assembly
80/129	Follow-up to and implementation of the outcomes of the International Conferences on Financing for Development	80/181	Promoting social integration through social inclusion
80/135	Promoting sustainable consumption and production patterns for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, building on Agenda 21	80/207	The right to development
		80/210	The right to food
<i>Economic and Social Council resolutions</i>			
671 A (XXV)	Establishment of an Economic Commission for Africa	2025/7	Strengthening solidarity, social inclusion and social cohesion to accelerate the delivery of the commitments of the Copenhagen Declaration on Social Development and Programme of Action of the World Summit for Social Development as well as the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
2021/10	Socially just transition towards sustainable development: the role of digital technologies on social development and well-being of all		
2024/5	Social dimensions of the New Partnership for Africa’s Development	2025/12	
2025/6	Social dimensions of the New Partnership for Africa’s Development	2025/23	
<i>Economic Commission for Africa resolutions</i>			
822 (XXXI); 914 (XLVII); 960 (LI); 972 (LIII); 2023/4; 2025/1	Regional integration and trade and strengthening regional economic communities	928 (XLVIII)	Implementing Agenda 2063: planning, mobilizing and financing for development
		931 (XLVIII); 973 (LIII); 2023/2	Data and statistical development
	874 (XLIII); 2025/1	Strengthening the subregional offices of the United Nations Economic Commission for Africa	934 (XLVIII)
907 (XLVI); 922 (XLVII); 975 (LIII)	Industrialization and diversification	935 (XLVII); 967 (LII); 977 (LIII); 987 (LIV)	Least developed countries in Africa
909 (XLVI)	Realizing and harnessing the demographic dividend in Africa		

Section 18 Economic and social development in Africa

937 (XLIX)	Mainstreaming the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and Agenda 2063 into national strategic frameworks, action plans and programmes	2023/1	Enhancing energy security and ensuring a just energy transition in Africa
		2023/11	African High-level Working Group on the Global Financial Architecture
938 (XLIX)	Integrated reporting and follow-up on sustainable development	2023/13	Strengthening the cooperation between the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission to address development challenges in Africa
939 (XLIX)	Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable Development		
941 (XLIX)	Organization of an annual African regional review of progress in the implementation of the outcomes of the World Summit on Information Society	2024/1	Strengthening tax cooperation for enhanced domestic resource mobilization
		2024/4	Optimizing African tax regimes concerning information and communications technology for economic growth and job creation
965 (LII); 988 (LIV)	Transport development		
966 (LII)	Review of the intergovernmental structure of the Economic Commission for Africa pursuant to its resolution 943 (XLIX) and resolution 957 (LI)	2025/1	Request to strengthen the capacity of the Economic Commission for Africa to fulfil its mandates and to provide its members with transformational, results-oriented policy and technical support
968 (LII); 2023/3	Fiscal policy, trade and the private sector in a digital era: a strategy for Africa	2025/3	Use of artificial intelligence to advance the socioeconomic development of Africa
969 (LII)	Digitization and the digital economy initiative	2025/5	Use of regional value chains to harness the wealth of Africa
972 (LIII)	African Continental Free Trade Area		
974 (LIII)	Civil registration and vital statistics		

Subprogramme 1

Macroeconomic policy, finance and governance

General Assembly resolutions

58/4	United Nations Convention against Corruption	79/190	Preventing and combating corrupt practices and the transfer of proceeds of corruption, facilitating asset recovery and returning such assets to legitimate owners, in particular to countries of origin, in accordance with the United Nations Convention against Corruption
65/286	Implementing the smooth transition strategy for countries graduating from the list of least developed countries		
66/209	Promoting the efficiency, accountability, effectiveness and transparency of public administration by strengthening supreme audit institutions	80/126	Promotion of international cooperation to combat illicit financial flows and strengthen good practices on assets return to foster sustainable development
66/256	The United Nations in global governance		
71/256	New Urban Agenda	80/128	Promotion of inclusive and effective international tax cooperation at the United Nations

Economic and Social Council resolution

2023/28	Report of the Committee of Experts on Public Administration on its twenty-second session		
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Economic Commission for Africa resolutions

879 (XLIV)	Governing development in Africa: the role of the State in economic transformation	916 (XLVII)	Illicit financial flows
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Subprogramme 2 Regional integration and trade

General Assembly resolution

80/124 Commodities

Economic Commission for Africa resolutions

847 (XL)	Aid for trade	891 (XLV)	Accelerating regional integration and boosting intra-African trade
867 (XLIII)	Assessment of progress on regional integration in Africa		

Subprogramme 3 Technology, innovation, connectivity and infrastructure development

General Assembly resolutions

76/294	Political Declaration of the High-Level Meeting on Improving Global Road Safety	80/173	Outcome document of the high-level meeting of the General Assembly on the overall review of the implementation of the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society
78/290	Improving global road safety		
80/147	Science, technology and innovation for sustainable development		

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2025/18	Assessment of the progress made in the implementation of and follow-up to the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society	2025/19	Science, technology and innovation for development
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Economic Commission for Africa resolutions

887 (XLIV)	Enhancing science and technology for development in Africa	2023/1	Enhancing energy security and ensuring a just energy transition in Africa
969 (LII)	Digitization and the digital economy initiative	2023/3	Digital transformation for a secure, inclusive and sustainable common future

Subprogramme 4 Data and statistics

General Assembly resolutions

68/261	Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics	69/282	World Statistics Day
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Economic and Social Council resolutions

2013/21	Fundamental Principles of Official Statistics	2025/13	2030 World Population and Housing Census Programme
2016/27	Strengthening institutional arrangements on geospatial information management	2025/26	Strengthening integration of statistics and geography
2022/24	Enhancing global geospatial information management arrangements		

Economic Commission for Africa resolutions

758 (XXVIII)	The role of cartography, remote sensing and geographic information systems (GIS) in sustainable development	882 (XLIV)	Implementation of the African Charter on Statistics and the Strategy for the Harmonization of Statistics in Africa
849 (XL)	Statistics and statistical capacity-building in Africa	911 (XLVI)	Statistics and statistical development
		2023/2	Data and statistics

Subprogramme 5

Climate change, food security and natural resources

General Assembly resolutions

76/300	The human right to a clean, healthy and sustainable environment	80/140	Implementation of the Convention on Biological Diversity and its contribution to sustainable development
80/110	Oceans and the law of the sea	80/157	Agriculture development, food security and nutrition
80/133	Agricultural technology for sustainable development		
80/137	Disaster risk reduction		

Economic Commission for Africa resolutions

818 (XXXI)	Promotion of mineral resources development and utilization in Africa	982 (LIV)	Financing the recovery of Africa and beyond
877 (XLIII)	Towards realizing a food-secure Africa	989 (LIV)	Carbon certification
884 (XLIV)	Climate change and sustainable development in Africa	2023/5	Accelerating food systems transformation in Africa
919 (XLVII)	Green economy and structural transformation in Africa	2023/6	Climate finance mobilization to accelerate a green recovery
975 (LIII)	Sustainable industrialization and diversification of Africa in the digital era in the context of the coronavirus disease pandemic	2023/7	Advancing the sustainable debt coalition initiative in Africa and beyond
		2023/8	Great Blue Wall Initiative

Subprogramme 6

Economic empowerment of women and youth

General Assembly resolutions

65/312	Outcome document of the High-level Meeting of the General Assembly on Youth: Dialogue and Mutual Understanding	78/150	Achieving gender equality and empowering all women and girls for realizing all Sustainable Development Goals
70/176	Taking action against gender-related killing of women and girls	78/188	The girl child
77/193 ; 79/152	Intensification of efforts to eliminate all forms of violence against women and girls	80/180	Policies and programmes involving youth
		80/184	Improvement of the situation of women and girls in rural areas
		80/185	Violence against women migrant workers

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2003/44 ; 2025/18	Gender digital divide	2025/4	Mainstreaming a gender perspective into all policies and programmes in the United Nations system
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Subprogramme 8

Economic development and planning

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2013/2	Refocusing and recalibrating the Economic Commission for Africa to support Africa's structural transformation	2023/17	Reinforcing the role of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning in assisting members of the Economic Commission for Africa in strengthening development planning and improving their capacity to formulate and manage effective public sector policies for structural transformation and sustainable development
2018/22	African Institute for Economic Development and Planning		

Economic Commission for Africa resolutions

58 (IV)	Establishment of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning	979 (LIII)	African Institute for Economic Development and Planning
858 (XLI)	Special Meeting of the Governing Council of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning		

Subprogramme 9

Poverty and socioeconomic policy

General Assembly resolutions

79/151	Literacy for life: shaping future agendas	80/146	Multidimensional vulnerability index
79/213	Promoting the social and solidarity economy for sustainable development	80/179	Follow-up to the Second World Assembly on Ageing

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2024/4	Promoting care and support systems for social development	2025/8	Modalities for the fifth review and appraisal of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing, 2002
2024/6	Fostering social development and social justice through social policies to accelerate progress on the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and to achieve the overarching goal of poverty eradication		

Deliverables

18.15 Table 18.1 lists all cross-cutting deliverables of the programme.

Table 18.1

Cross-cutting deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	7	18	7	17
1. Coordination meetings on the African Union-United Nations Framework for the Implementation of Agenda 2063 and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	1	1	1	1
2. Annual Africa Business Forum	1	1	1	1
3. Meetings of the Regional Coordination Platform for Africa	2	3	2	2
4. Meetings of the Fifth Committee	1	1	1	1
5. Meetings of the Committee for Programme and Coordination	1	1	1	1
6. Meetings of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	1	1	1	1
7. Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development	–	10	–	10
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Publications (number of publications)	2	1	2	1
8. Overview of economic and social conditions in Africa for the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development and the Committee of Experts of the Economic Commission for Africa	1	1	1	1
9. On the African Union-United Nations Framework for the Implementation of Agenda 2063 and the 2030 Agenda	1	–	1	–

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advocacy and advisory services on the African Union-United Nations Framework for the Implementation of Agenda 2063 and the 2030 Agenda.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: information materials on regional integration and emerging socioeconomic issues for awareness-raising with members of ECA.				

Evaluation activities

- 18.16 Eight project evaluations conducted by ECA and completed in 2025, in the areas of African Continental Free Trade Area implementation, industrialization, climate-resilient development pathways, and migration, have guided the proposed programme plan for 2027.
- 18.17 In response to the results of the evaluations referenced above, ECA will integrate lessons learned and recommendations to inform the implementation and the design of the next phases of the projects. For example, projects to operationalize the African Continental Free Trade Area will strengthen its communication and outreach strategies to ensure a more targeted approach, with a view to fostering deeper stakeholder engagement and effective uptake of trade preferences and instruments. In addition, ECA will strive to enhance focus areas of project interventions to leverage its comparative advantage and avoid duplication of interventions at the country level.
- 18.18 The following evaluations to be conducted by ECA are planned for 2027:
- (a) Five project evaluations on ECA support in the areas of trade, public finance, climate finance, and digitalization of civil registration and vital statistics systems;
 - (b) Programme evaluation on digitalization and data policies in Africa.

Subprogramme 1

Macroeconomic policy, finance and governance

Objective

- 18.19 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to achieve structural transformation and inclusive growth in Africa through strengthened and effective development planning, macroeconomic policy analysis, enhanced economic governance and management, and innovative public and private sector financing.

Strategy

- 18.20 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Provide technical assistance, capacity-building and policy advice to members of ECA on:
 - (i) Tracking progress in the implementation of the 2030 Agenda, Agenda 2063 and the Doha Programme of Action, and designing, implementing and monitoring their national development plans;
 - (ii) Designing and implementing policy frameworks that promote transparency and accountability in public financial management, including debt management, and resource mobilization and allocation to build resilience to shocks;
 - (iii) Identifying priority growth sectors and promoting the development and implementation of initiatives to improve their competitiveness, attract investment and stimulate entrepreneurship;

- (iv) Developing and deepening their domestic capital markets and developing innovative and sustainable financing solutions for mobilizing additional resources to meet development financing needs;
 - (v) Enhancing the credibility, transparency and resilience of African economies through improved sovereign credit ratings, thereby facilitating access to affordable financing through better risk perception;
 - (vi) Promoting sustainable urbanization that enhances job creation, revenues and urban social protection.
- (b) Convene platforms for policy dialogue on matters related to macroeconomic policy, economic governance, financing and development planning, including the annual session of the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development and the biennial session of the Committee on Economic Governance;
 - (c) Publish policy-relevant knowledge products underpinned by research and macroeconomic modelling tools and produce, upon request, forecasts with recommendations for responding to the impacts of external shocks.

18.21 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) More coordinated and integrated policy design and implementation by members of ECA;
- (b) Accelerated and sustainable graduation of African countries from the least developed country category;
- (c) Increased mobilization of resources and capital for development and investment in priority areas;
- (d) Improved debt management and reduced debt vulnerabilities among members of ECA;
- (e) An enabling environment that allows for improved access to markets and a diversified investor base with an increased appetite for domestic currency debt markets;
- (f) Improved borrowing conditions and greater fiscal space to drive sustainable economic and social development;
- (g) Improved economic and financial resilience in African cities.

Programme performance in 2025

Strengthened debt management and sustainable financing strategies in small island developing States

18.22 Multiple global crises continue to severely impact developing countries, particularly small island developing States, by disrupting their economic activities and value chains, further exacerbating their fiscal vulnerabilities. The subprogramme provided support to Cabo Verde and the Comoros to address heightened fiscal constraints, compounded by limited access to external financing for their development priorities. The intervention aimed to strengthen debt management and external financing frameworks by enhancing the capacity of the two countries in designing their financing strategies. The subprogramme, in collaboration with UNCTAD, conducted debt sustainability analyses, risk and resilience assessments related to the impacts of climate change, and external financing diagnostics, to identify practical pathways to mobilize sustainable and affordable external financing while containing debt vulnerabilities in the countries. This led to the development of national financing strategies and corresponding implementation road maps to guide implementation in Cabo Verde and the Comoros.

18.23 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.2).

Table 18.2
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	Enhanced diagnostic capacity of small island developing States in the areas of domestic resource mobilization, debt management, macroeconomic stability, and financial recovery	Cabo Verde and the Comoros developed comprehensive national financing strategies and road maps that will enable them to effectively mobilize affordable external financial resources, supporting more equitable sustainable development while ensuring alignment with external financial and public debt sustainability

Planned results for 2027**Result 1: members of ECA apply innovative approaches to mobilize domestic resources and external private capital****Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027**

- 18.24 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development of Islamic finance guidelines in Uganda by the Capital Markets Authority to expand sukuk markets and increase product offerings and to the development and implementation of market infrastructure upgrades in Botswana, which met the planned target.
- 18.25 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.3).

Table 18.3
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Uganda designed a strategic plan and road map for the development of its local currency bond market	The United Republic of Tanzania adopted an interest rate-based monetary policy framework	Uganda developed Islamic finance guidelines by the Capital Markets Authority with the aim to expand sukuk markets and increase product offerings	Two members of ECA initiate implementation of their programmes to increase finance for development	One additional member of ECA develops a programme to deepen its financial system
Development of the first securities exchange in Ethiopia	Botswana implemented the Bank of Botswana (Amendment) Act, which included measures on the establishment of the Monetary Policy Committee and a deposit insurance scheme	Botswana undertook major market infrastructure upgrades to boost settlement efficiency, strengthen operational resilience, and ensure greater alignment with international market standards		
Strengthened governance and improved sovereign risk management in Guinea and Mauritania				

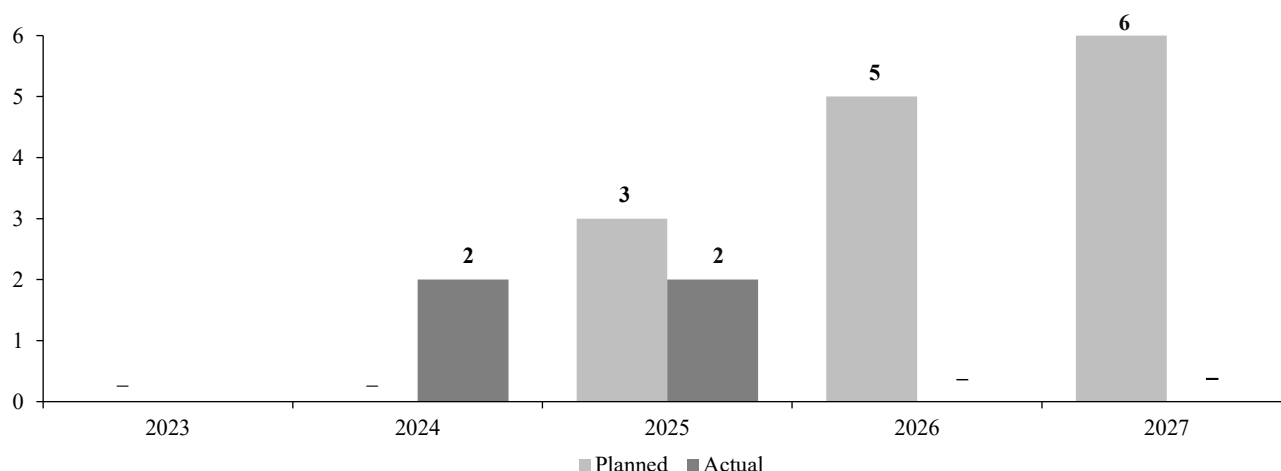
Result 2: enhanced macroeconomic forecasting and development planning for inclusive and sustainable growth

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.26 The subprogramme's work contributed to strengthened national capacity for macroeconomic forecasting and evidence-based planning in Botswana, which did not meet the planned target of one additional country applying macroeconomic analysis tools in the development of national development plans. The target was not met due to the need for further consultations with additional line ministries in the preparation of the national development plan.
- 18.27 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.I).

Figure 18.I

Performance measure: number of members of ECA applying macroeconomic analysis tools in the development of national development plans (cumulative)



Result 3: improved economic and financial governance to enhance structural transformation and inclusive development

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.28 Effective economic and financial governance strengthens domestic resource mobilization, creates a conducive environment for investment, and directs resources effectively to foster inclusive development and structural transformation. The subprogramme provided technical support to members of ECA to improve their tax administration, including the rationalization of tax expenditures, tackling profit shifting, and enhancing resource mobilization. In addition, support was provided in developing sovereign credit rating frameworks aligned with international standards to better prepare for effective engagement with credit rating agencies.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.29 The lesson for the subprogramme was the need to support members of ECA to develop robust governance frameworks to improve credit ratings and tax administration systems. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will provide technical support and capacity-building to members of ECA on strengthening their governance frameworks to improve their domestic resource mobilization and sovereign credit rating.
- 18.30 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.4).

Table 18.4
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Benin developed a national action plan for rationalizing tax expenditure	Zambia developed a national action plan for rationalizing tax expenditure	Uganda developed a national plan for addressing profit shifting and adjusted audit procedures to enhance monitoring and evaluation	Two additional members of ECA develop measures to strengthen their tax systems	One additional member of ECA develops measures to strengthen its tax system
	Ethiopia strengthened its credit rating framework through the Ethiopian Capital Market Authority by issuing a new credit rating directive and launching a programme to build local expertise	Ethiopia developed national guidelines to manage tax incentives	Two additional members of ECA develop measures to strengthen sovereign rating management	Two additional members of ECA develop measures to strengthen sovereign rating management
		Guinea developed a regulatory framework to strengthen credit rating management		

Deliverables

18.31 Table 18.5 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 18.5
Subprogramme 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	2	2	2
1. Overview of economic and social conditions in Africa to the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development and the Committee of Experts of the Economic Commission for Africa	1	1	1	1
2. Progress report on the implementation of the priority areas of the Doha Programme of Action for the Least Developed Countries for the decade 2022–2031 to the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development and the Committee of Experts of the Economic Commission for Africa	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	–	–	4	–
3. Meetings of the Committee on Economic Governance	–	–	4	–
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	14	10	9	6
4. On countering illicit financial flows from Africa	1	1	1	–
5. On the use of the ECA macroeconomic model for selected countries	1	1	1	1
6. On the integrated planning and reporting toolkit	3	2	1	1
7. Internship and fellowship programme for young African economists to build their capacity to formulate, implement and monitor development policies and programmes	1	1	1	1

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
8. On strengthening the capacity of members of ECA in public finance	3	1	2	–
9. On market access and private sector financing, investment and risks	2	1	2	2
10. On capital market development	2	2	–	–
11. On urbanization and development to build the capacity of policymakers	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	13	18	11	8
12. Workshop on macroeconomic modelling for African policymakers and experts	1	1	1	1
13. Training event on public finance and development planning in Africa (policy dialogue)	2	5	1	1
14. Workshop on market access and private sector financing, investment and risks	5	7	4	4
15. Workshops on urbanization and development to build the policy capacity of members of ECA	5	5	5	2
Publications (number of publications)	4	4	3	4
16. Africa Sustainable Development Report	1	1	1	1
17. Economic Report on Africa	1	1	1	1
18. Economic Governance Report	1	1	–	1
19. On the state of urbanization in Africa for evidence-based policymaking	1	1	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	17	14	8	8
20. On emerging economic issues and challenges to growth and development in Africa	3	3	1	1
21. Policy briefs on emerging issues related to macroeconomic analysis, economic governance and public finance	3	3	1	1
22. Africa economic performance and outlook report	4	2	2	2
23. Sovereign credit rating outlook	2	2	2	2
24. On market access and private sector financing, investment and risks	1	1	1	1
25. On purchase-agreement markets among African regulators and market stakeholders	1	–	–	–
26. On urbanization	3	3	1	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services to seven members of ECA and regional bodies on emerging macroeconomic issues, development planning and economic governance issues.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: Pan-African Conference on Illicit Financial Flows and Taxation.				

Subprogramme 2

Regional integration and trade

Objective

- 18.32 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen regional cooperation and integration among members of ECA through increased trade flows, improved industrialization and increased investment.

Strategy

- 18.33 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Provide advisory services and technical assistance to members of ECA on market access and business opportunities arising from the African Continental Free Trade Area to minimize potential adverse effects (such as import surges, dumping and customs revenue loss risks) in the context of the implementation of their national strategies, and multilateral and bilateral trade issues;

- (b) Develop and disseminate knowledge products and provide technical assistance to identify opportunities for diversification, value addition and the development of manufacturing and industrial clusters for members of ECA in support of the Action Plan for the Accelerated Industrial Development of Africa, contributing to the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 9 and 17;
- (c) Provide training, with a particular focus on least developed countries, landlocked developing countries and regional economic communities, on the implementation of existing regional cooperation frameworks;
- (d) Provide advisory services and technical assistance to members of ECA and regional economic communities on regional integration, national, regional and continental competition policies, intellectual property policies and measures for investment facilitation.

18.34 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Improved implementation by countries of their respective strategies for the operationalization of the African Continental Free Trade Area;
- (b) More coherent, coordinated and responsive interfaces between the African Continental Free Trade Area and the free trade areas and customs unions of the regional economic communities;
- (c) More coherent trade and industrialization policies aligned with the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063;
- (d) Accelerated industrialization and increased diversification of productive capacities and production patterns;
- (e) Reduced transaction risks and intermediation costs for members of ECA;
- (f) An improved business environment characterized by enhanced opportunities for private sector operators to leverage transboundary opportunities and improved market access conditions for African trade of goods and services, as well as the free movement of capital and people.

Programme performance in 2025

Enhanced readiness of Ethiopia to trade under the African Continental Free Trade Area

18.35 Ethiopia's effective participation in the African Continental Free Trade Area is a strategic priority for accelerating export diversification, regional value chain integration, and private sector competitiveness. As a late entrant to preferential trade arrangements, Ethiopia faces specific structural, regulatory and institutional constraints that would need to be addressed to translate African Continental Free Trade Area commitments into tangible trading outcomes for firms, particularly small and medium-sized enterprises. To address these gaps, the subprogramme supported Ethiopia in strengthening its operational readiness to trade under the African Continental Free Trade Area by addressing policy, regulatory and implementation bottlenecks across goods and services trade. Key interventions focused on enhancing national coordination mechanisms, strengthening the understanding of the African Continental Free Trade Area among public and private stakeholders, and supporting evidence-based engagement in continental negotiations. Technical assistance and capacity-building activities helped national institutions to align domestic trade policies, customs procedures, and trade facilitation frameworks with African Continental Free Trade Area requirements, while targeted analytical work supported Ethiopia's positioning in priority sectors with regional export potential. These interventions contributed to improved institutional preparedness and clearer national positions on African Continental Free Trade Area implementation and strengthened the capacity of Ethiopian trade officials and private sector actors to utilize African Continental Free Trade Area preferences effectively.

18.36 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.6).

Table 18.6
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	Ethiopia formulated its African Continental Free Trade Area implementation strategy, in consultation with relevant stakeholders from the public and private sectors	Ethiopia became better positioned to operationalize African Continental Free Trade Area commitments, reduce trade costs and progressively integrate into intra-African markets, supporting inclusive growth, job creation, and structural transformation in line with national development priorities and continental integration objectives Ethiopia also launched its first duty-free exports under the African Continental Free Trade Area

Planned results for 2027

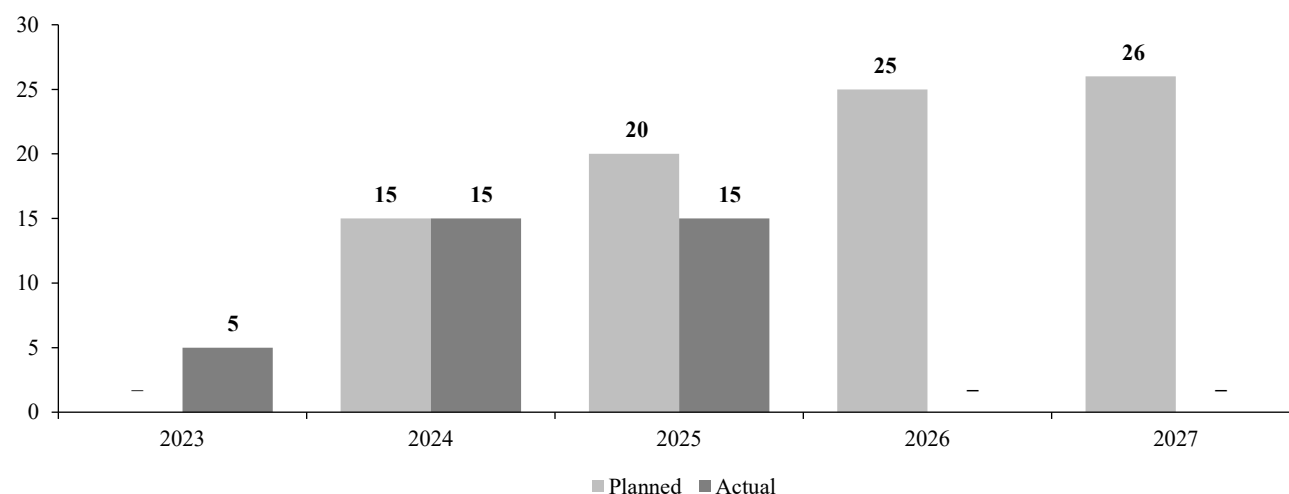
Result 1: sustainable trade strategies to mitigate the impact of climate change

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.37 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development of sustainable trade strategies that include considerations related to climate change in five countries, which did not meet the planned target of five additional members of ECA adopting sustainable trade strategies that include considerations related to climate change. The target was not met due to the need for further data collection to finalize the strategies.
- 18.38 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.II).

Figure 18.II

Performance measure: number of members of ECA adopting sustainable trade strategies that include considerations related to climate change (cumulative)



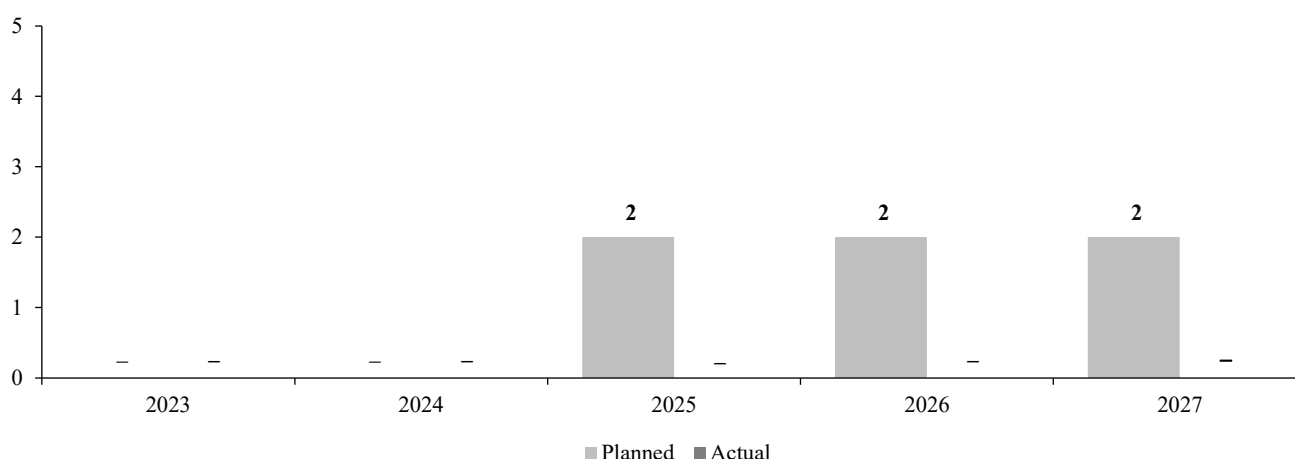
Result 2: members of ECA adopt measures to de-risk investments in regional value chains and special economic zones

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.39 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development and validation of an evidence-based framework on standards and norms for successful special economic zones and regional value chains, which did not meet the planned target of two ECA member States adopting measures to de-risk investments in regional value chains and special economic zones. The target was not met because of the depth of the analytical work and focus on generating robust evidence and consensus-building among key stakeholders.
- 18.40 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.III).

Figure 18.III

Performance measure: number of ECA member States adopting measures to de-risk investments in regional value chains and special economic zones (annual)



Result 3: improved national policy and institutional environment for the private sector to participate in intra-African trade through the African Continental Free Trade Area

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.41 Effective participation in the African Continental Free Trade Area and related trade reforms requires sustained institutional readiness and negotiation capacity at the national and regional levels. Although many member States and regional economic communities have made progress in aligning policies with African Continental Free Trade Area commitments, disparities persist in their ability to negotiate, articulate national and regional interests, and consistently operationalize agreed trade rules. These gaps affect the depth and effectiveness of participation in trade processes and limit the realization of integration gains.

Lessons learned and planned change

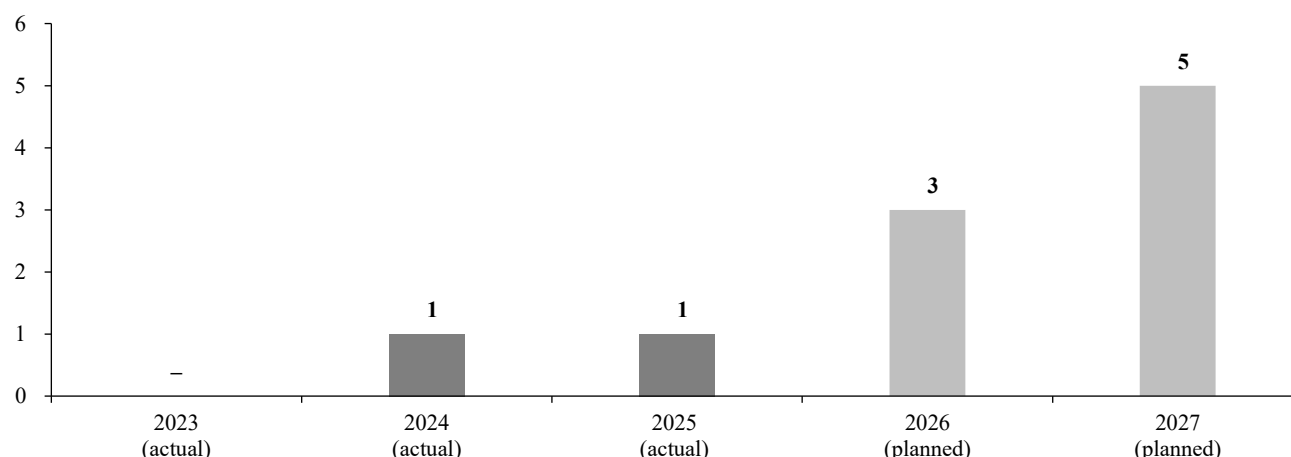
- 18.42 The lesson for the subprogramme was that, while analytical products, policy frameworks and regional-level engagements remain essential, their impact on observable change was greatest when complemented by more targeted, country-level and regional economic community-specific approaches. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will place greater emphasis on approaches tailored to the institutional readiness of beneficiaries, with increased focus on country- and regional economic community-level application of trade rules, negotiation scenarios and operational decision-making. Building on progress achieved in previous periods, the subprogramme will support members of ECA by increasing awareness of African Continental Free Trade Area provisions and

providing tailored technical assistance towards institutional alignment with the African Continental Free Trade Area and strengthening policy frameworks through practical step-by-step trade guides.

18.43 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.IV).

Figure 18.IV

Performance measure: number of members of ECA deploying African Continental Free Trade Area step-by-step guides to support private sector traders (cumulative)



Deliverables

18.44 Table 18.7 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 18.7

Subprogramme 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	2	2	1
1. Report for the Committee on Private Sector Development, Regional Integration, Trade, Infrastructure, Industry and Technology	1	1	1	1
2. Report on the status of implementation of the Awaza Programme of Action for Landlocked Developing Countries for the Decade 2024–2034 for the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development and updates on the status of international and intra-African trade for the Committee on Private Sector Development, Regional Integration, Trade, Infrastructure, Industry and Technology	1	1	1	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	3	3	–	3
3. Meetings of the Committee on Private Sector Development, Regional Integration, Trade, Infrastructure, Industry and Technology	3	3	–	3
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	4	5	6	4
4. On boosting intra-African trade by enhancing the capacity of members of ECA and regional economic communities to increase the African share of international trade	1	1	1	–
5. Fellowship programme for enhancing the capacity of young African scholars in the areas of industrialization, investment, regional integration, trade and markets	1	1	1	1
6. On the trade model	1	1	1	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
7. On operationalization of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area: strategic interventions in investment, services competition policy, digitalization, regional trade and integration	1	1	3	1
8. On de-risking investment in Africa towards catalysing intra-African trade, sustainable industrialization and economic diversification	–	1	–	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	10	10	10	10
9. Training events on trade economics, regional integration and capacity-building for trade policy and structural transformation, aid for trade, basic and intermediate trade modelling and advanced trade modelling	10	10	10	10
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	2	2
10. Topical issue report on the second phase of the African Continental Free Trade Area negotiations	1	–	1	1
11. On assessing regional integration in Africa	–	1	–	1
12. On revisiting policy, legislation and institutions for industrial development in Africa	1	1	1	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	11	11	10	3
13. On investments	3	3	3	1
14. On topical international and intraregional trade issues	5	5	5	1
15. On the African Union integration agenda	1	1	1	–
16. On industrialization in Africa	2	2	1	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services to members of ECA and regional or subregional cooperation groups in the context of the New Partnership for Africa's Development and the Framework for a Renewed United Nations-African Union Partnership on Africa's Integration and Development Agenda 2017–2027; analytical advice for the implementation of the Awaza Programme of Action.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: Africa Regional Integration Index; regional digital trade integration database; digital services trade restrictiveness database.				
Communication deliverables:				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: information materials on regional integration and trade; information kits; high-level policy dialogue on trade.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: content for the subprogramme's social media accounts on regional integration and trade.				

Subprogramme 3 Technology, innovation, connectivity and infrastructure development

Objective

- 18.45 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance inclusive growth, sustainable development and economic transformation in Africa through science, technology and innovation, improved connectivity, logistics and infrastructure development.

Strategy

- 18.46 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Conduct policy research and analysis on:
 - (i) Digital trends on the continent, including those related to the economic impact of new and emerging technologies and technology-driven solutions for sustainable development;

- (ii) The state of energy, transport, and information and communications technology (ICT) infrastructure at the national and regional levels and the impact of logistics and connectivity on economic development;
- (b) Provide technical assistance and advisory services to members of ECA, the African Union and its bodies, and subregional organizations on:
 - (i) The design and implementation of regulatory frameworks that promote infrastructure, digital systems and policies related to technology and innovation, including principles for good digital identification, data governance, ICT security, financial technology and responsible use of artificial intelligence;
 - (ii) The design and implementation of policies and strategies to bridge technological and innovation gaps and promote digital inclusivity and digital connectivity across the continent;
 - (iii) The development of an academic and entrepreneurial ecosystem for science, technology and innovation through partnerships and capacity-building initiatives with a view to developing a critical mass of researchers, experts and innovators for evidence-based decision-making and innovation-driven growth in member States;
 - (iv) The implementation of the Programme for Infrastructure Development in Africa and the design of regulatory frameworks to enhance private sector investment in infrastructure while managing risk;
 - (v) The development of transport infrastructure and services, including transport facilitation, norms and standards, regulations, road safety and asset management, and a particular focus on the liberalization of intra-African air transport in the context of the Single African Air Transport Market and the digitalization of transport infrastructure;
 - (vi) The development of infrastructure to improve energy access, advance market development, and foster the transition to renewable sources of energy.

18.47 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Improved digital ecosystems across the continent, enabling the implementation of better policy and regulatory frameworks that enhance the use of digital public infrastructure, innovation and digital systems;
- (b) Strengthened and enhanced digital inclusivity and connectivity in members of ECA and across the continent, through effective policies and strategies, reducing technological disparities and ensuring broader access to digital resources and innovations;
- (c) A strengthened science, technology and innovation ecosystem with a greater number of capacity-building initiatives, leading to a critical mass of researchers, experts and innovators driving evidence-based decision-making and innovation-driven growth;
- (d) Increased efficiency and safety of the African transport sector;
- (e) Increased energy access and innovative financing for energy infrastructure;
- (f) Increased private sector investment in new and emerging technologies and public infrastructure.

18.48 In doing so, the subprogramme will support members of ECA in making progress towards Sustainable Development Goals 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 13 and 17.

Programme performance in 2025

Member States have access to a tax policy simulation tool to support evidence-based policymaking for affordable connectivity, inclusive economic growth, and job creation in Africa

- 18.49 Digital connectivity is a key driver of economic growth, employment and social inclusion in Africa. However, many individuals and businesses still face barriers due to high access costs (continental average of 14.8 per cent of gross national income per capita, nearly five times the global average) and limited broadband investments. Cognizant of these challenges, the subprogramme developed a technical report on optimizing Africa's ICT tax regimes towards economic growth and job creation to inform policymakers of the economic and fiscal impacts of ICT taxation and to provide evidence-based recommendations for digital transformation. Key findings from the subprogramme's research include the finding that a 10 per cent increase in mobile broadband penetration yields growth in gross domestic product by approximately 2.5 per cent and in employment rates between 3.1 per cent and 13.2 per cent. In addition, the subprogramme developed the ICT Tax Impact Calculator, a practical policy tool that enables Governments to simulate country-specific ICT tax reform scenarios and assess their potential economic and fiscal impacts. In 2025, the tool was presented and validated to demonstrate that the reduction of sector-specific excise duties can boost aggregate tax receipts by expanding the tax base, with a view to supporting the adoption of evidence-based fiscal policies that promote digital inclusion, revenue generation and job creation.
- 18.50 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.8).

Table 18.8
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Member States have access to the ICT Tax Impact Calculator to simulate country-specific ICT tax reform scenarios and assess their potential economic and fiscal impacts

Planned result for 2027

Result 1: increased use of new technologies by members of ECA, reinforced by robust regulatory frameworks

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.51 The subprogramme's work contributed to two regional transport corridor authorities (the Central Corridor Transit Transport Facilitation Agency and the Northern Corridor Transit and Transport Coordination Authority) using data generated through artificial intelligence to manage their infrastructure assets through a web-based platform developed by the subprogramme, which met the planned target.
- 18.52 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.9).

Table 18.9
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Continental Artificial Intelligence Strategy and African Digital Compact endorsed by the African Union Commission	Two regional transport corridor authorities (the Central Corridor Transit Transport Facilitation Agency and the Northern Corridor Transit and Transport Coordination Authority) use data generated through artificial intelligence to manage their infrastructure assets	Two countries apply artificial intelligence to road safety One member State develops a national artificial intelligence strategy	Two regional corridors operationalize a digital platform to manage their transport infrastructure assets At least two member States develop national digital transformation strategies to enhance public service delivery

Result 2: members of ECA leverage technology and innovation to manage their transport and energy infrastructure

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.53 The programme's work contributed to one member of ECA (Ghana) applying digital technologies in managing its energy infrastructure assets, with Ghana applying the Model for Analysis of Energy Demand (MAED-2) for long-term energy planning, which did not meet the planned target of two members of ECA. The target was not met due to delays experienced in one country, where a geospatial platform was developed to manage energy infrastructure assets but has not yet been operationalized.
- 18.54 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.10).

Table 18.10
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Egypt, Kenya and Madagascar utilized web-based platforms to monitor transport corridors Madagascar used GIS and satellite imagery to assess its energy resources	Ghana applied the Model for Analysis of Energy Demand (MAED-2) for long-term energy planning	Two additional countries apply digital technologies in managing their transport and energy infrastructure assets	Two additional countries apply digital technologies in managing their transport and energy infrastructure assets

Result 3: strengthened strategies and policies for infrastructure development

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.55 Infrastructure development is a key driver of sustainable development on the continent and a critical enabler for trade, economic growth and regional integration. Research conducted by ECA indicates that the continent's infrastructure deficit reduces economic growth by 2 per cent annually and cuts productivity by up to 40 per cent. The subprogramme supports member States and regional organizations through technical assistance, capacity-building, and knowledge-sharing in infrastructure development, with a view to accelerating structural transformation, promote innovation-driven growth and foster regional integration.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.56 The lesson for the subprogramme was the need to provide more targeted support at the regional and country levels for the development of comprehensive infrastructure strategies, including through a stronger focus on financing approaches, given that access to adequate financing remains a key challenge. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will strengthen its support to members of ECA and regional entities in the development and validation of infrastructure strategies, including by expanding tailored advisory services, promoting innovative and sustainable financing solutions, and deepening engagement with national stakeholders and United Nations country teams.
- 18.57 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.11).

Table 18.11

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	—	Eswatini and the Gambia developed road safety strategies	Three members of ECA or regional organizations develop and validate infrastructure strategies	Two additional members of ECA or regional organizations develop and validate infrastructure strategies

Deliverables

- 18.58 Table 18.12 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 18.12

Subprogramme 3: deliverables for the period 2024–2026 by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	3	6	2	3
1. Report for the Committee on Private Sector Development, Regional Integration, Trade, Infrastructure, Industry and Technology	1	2	–	1
2. Report on new technologies and innovative solutions for the transformation of Africa and implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals for the Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable Development and the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development and the Committee of Experts of the Economic Commission for Africa	1	3	1	1
3. Report on the implementation of the outcomes of the World Summit on the Information Society in Africa	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	12	21	12	16
4. Meetings of the Committee on Private Sector Development, Regional Integration, Trade, Infrastructure, Industry and Technology	4	4	–	4
5. African Regional Science, Technology and Innovation Forum, in preparation for the high-level political forum on sustainable development	4	4	4	4
6. Africa World Summit on the Information Society review meeting	4	4	4	4
7. African Internet Governance Forum	–	9	4	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	4	2	6	6
8. Public-private partnerships for financing the energy transition and infrastructure in Africa	1	–	1	–
9. On regulatory improvement to de-risk investment in the electricity market	1	1	1	1
10. On the establishment and operationalization of a digital technology centre	1	–	–	–
11. Fellowship programme for young African scholars on policy research, analysis and advocacy	1	1	–	–
12. On the implementation of connectivity projects	–	–	1	1
13. On the operationalization of the Single African Air Transport Market	–	–	1	2
14. On the application of science and technology in the transport sector	–	–	1	–
15. On the development of digital platforms	–	–	1	1
16. On fostering digital entrepreneurship among women in Africa	–	–	–	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	20	25	14	17
17. Workshop on regulatory analysis using regulatory openness, attractiveness and readiness methodology and reform planning	3	8	–	2
18. Workshops on technology adoption	9	9	9	9
19. Workshop on a continental regulatory framework for private sector investment in the energy sector	4	3	–	–
20. Seminar on low-emission hydrogen	1	3	1	–
21. Training on digitalization and use of artificial intelligence in regional transport corridors in Africa	1	1	1	1
22. Regional training on the scaled adoption of electric vehicles	2	1	1	–
23. Forum of the Alliance of Entrepreneurial Universities in Africa	–	–	2	1
24. Training on sustainable transport	–	–	–	1
25. Workshop to validate nuclear energy financing strategy and nuclear industrialization road map	–	–	–	1
26. Workshops to develop and validate infrastructure strategies	–	–	–	2

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
Publications (number of publications)	3	2	5	3
27. On emerging issues and trends in new technologies and innovation in the context of sustainable development	2	1	2	2
28. On African science, technology and innovation	1	1	1	1
29. On the performance of public-private partnerships in Uganda and Zambia	–	–	2	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	18	15	10	7
30. On energy access, for the high-level political forum on sustainable development	1	1	1	1
31. On the African transport policy programme	1	1	1	1
32. On road safety policies, strategies and action plans	2	2	2	2
33. On supporting regional railway infrastructure development in Africa	1	1	–	–
34. Methodology approach for the assessment of road corridors using GIS and other digitalized tools	1	1	1	–
35. Infographics on the African Continental Free Trade Area and demand for transport infrastructure and services	1	–	–	–
36. Infographics on the African strategic directions for the post-2020 Decade of Action for Road Safety	1	–	–	–
37. Documentation for meetings of the African Union and the African Union Development Agency in the areas of new technologies and innovation	1	1	–	–
38. On energy security in Africa	1	1	–	2
39. On the implementation of principles for good digital identification	2	1	2	–
40. Policy brief on low-emission hydrogen technology and application in Africa	2	2	1	–
41. Performance assessment of the Single African Air Transport Market	1	1	1	1
42. Regulatory readiness assessment for the electric vehicle market	3	3	1	–

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services to members of ECA and regional bodies on issues related to technology, innovation, connectivity and infrastructure development, including road safety, e-mobility infrastructure asset management, private sector investment in energy infrastructure and the use of digital tools, and digital identification.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: booklets on digital transformation and emerging technologies, and on infrastructure development; and brochures, newsletters, flyers, policy briefs and information kits covering technology, energy and transport-related issues including connectivity, innovation, road safety, nuclear energy and infrastructure development for ECA member States and implementing partners.

External and media relations: press releases, podcasts and videos on relevant issues.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: websites, social media and platforms on technology and infrastructure.

Databases and substantive digital materials: Africa transport database.

Subprogramme 4 Data and statistics

Objective

- 18.59 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen the production, dissemination and use of credible data, statistics and geospatial information at the national, regional and global levels for evidence-based policy and decision-making.

Strategy

- 18.60 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:

- (a) Support African national statistical systems in transforming their data governance and management methods by digitalizing the data collection, compilation and dissemination process for statistical areas, including censuses and civil registration systems, and provide technical assistance and training in the design and implementation of national strategies for the development of statistics and national spatial data infrastructure with related integrated geospatial information frameworks;
- (b) Maintain and regularly update databases that are accessible for public use, with available harmonized data, statistics and geospatial information disaggregated by location on such topics as African economies, demographics, social indicators, the environment and other statistics needed for monitoring and reporting on the implementation of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063;
- (c) Provide training and make platforms available for the exchange of best practices among members of ECA and their respective statistical agencies;
- (d) Integrate policy advice and sustained capacity-building activities on data, statistics and geospatial information to support members of ECA in enhancing monitoring and reporting on the implementation of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063;
- (e) Enhance communication and advocacy to members of ECA on the use of statistics and geospatial information;
- (f) Enhance collaboration with policymakers and key data users to co-create innovative, user-oriented and digitally enabled statistical products that improve accessibility and strengthen their use in evidence-based policymaking.

18.61 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Improved capacity, resilience and efficiency of national statistical systems, including the uptake of innovative tools and technologies to collect comparable statistics at various levels of disaggregation, and improved statistical operations, including the conduct of censuses and surveys and administrative data processing and analysis, and dissemination of timely data;
- (b) Improved uptake of geospatial information management, closer collaboration between components and stakeholders of the national spatial data infrastructures, and better integrated geospatial information frameworks;
- (c) Enhanced monitoring and reporting on the implementation of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063;
- (d) Increased availability and uptake of innovative, user-oriented and digitally enabled statistical products, leading to improved accessibility and more effective use of official statistics in evidence-based policymaking.

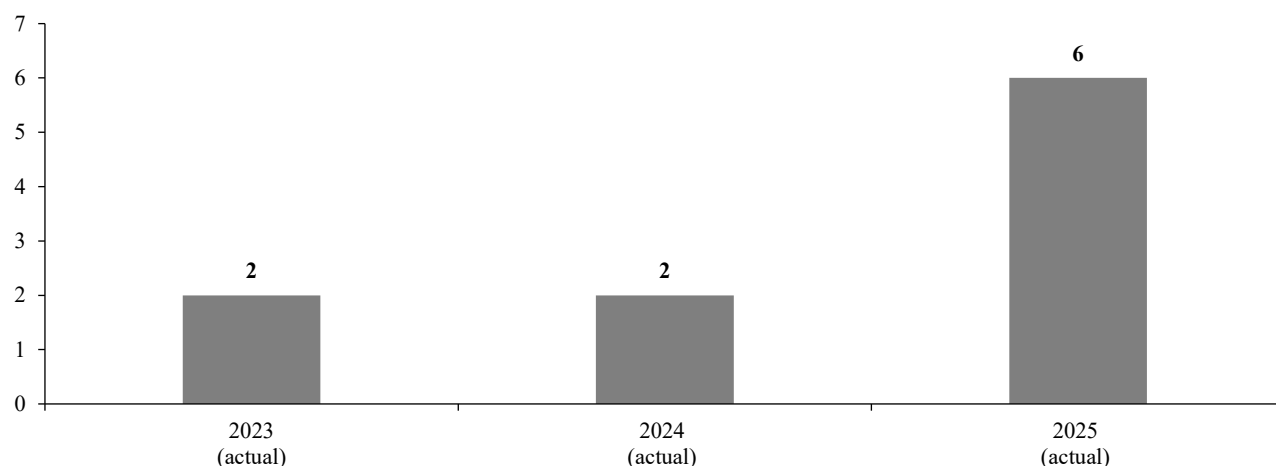
Programme performance in 2025

Members of ECA produce and use improved economic statistics for regional integration policies

- 18.62 Improving the integration and consistency of key economic data sets covering production statistics, supply and use frameworks, input-output structures and trade data enables more robust measurement of production structures and trade flows. The subprogramme strengthened the capacities of members of ECA and regional institutions to produce and analyse core economic statistics relevant to trade and regional integration, including the development of semi-automated routines to integrate and generate supply and use tables, input-output tables and trade in value added indicators, which together form a structured framework for analysing economic interconnectedness. Ten African countries are now integrated into the African Continental Input-Output Table, with trade in value added indicators generated, thereby enhancing their capacity to formulate more accurate regional integration policies.
- 18.63 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.V).

Figure 18.V

Performance measure: number of members of ECA producing data integrated into the continental input-output table and trade in value added framework (annual)



Planned results for 2027

Result 1: progress towards integrated statistical and geospatial information frameworks

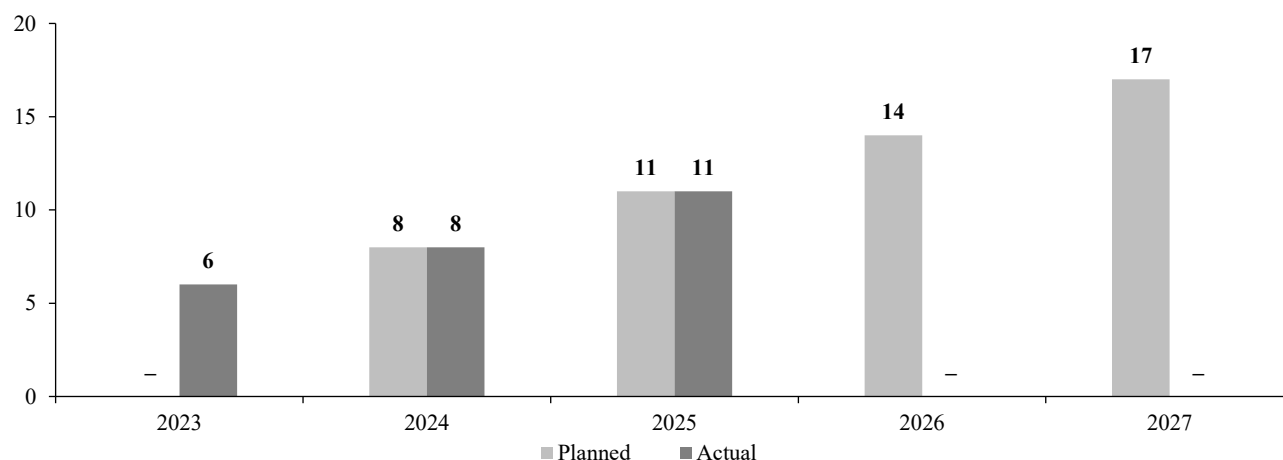
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

18.64 The subprogramme's work contributed to the application of the strategic pathways of the United Nations Integrated Geospatial Information Framework by three additional members of ECA (Eritrea, Ghana and Namibia), which met the planned target.

18.65 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.VI).

Figure 18.VI

Performance measure: number of members of ECA applying at least one of the strategic pathways of the United Nations Integrated Geospatial Information Framework (cumulative)

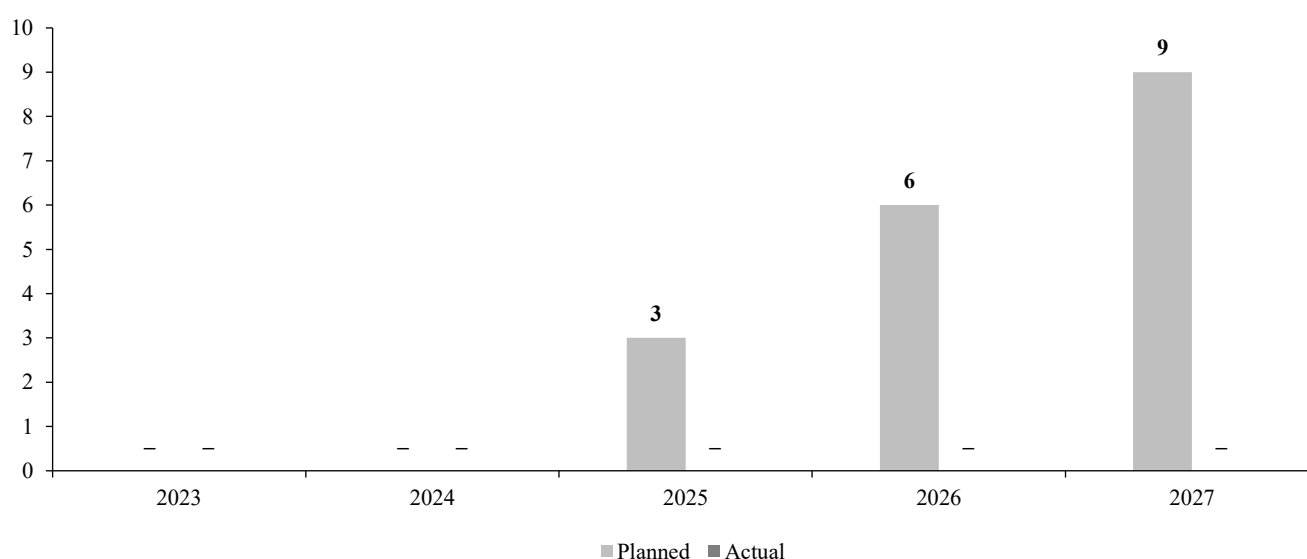


Result 2: improved civil registration and vital statistics systems**Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027**

- 18.66 The subprogramme's work contributed to strengthened capacity of four members of ECA (Burundi, Kenya, Namibia and United Republic of Tanzania) in civil registration and vital statistics pipeline applications, which did not meet the planned target of three members of ECA adopting innovative technology applications. The target was not met due to the need for further training prior to the adoption of the applications.
- 18.67 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.VII).

Figure 18.VII

Performance measure: number of members of ECA adopting innovative technology applications in civil registration and vital statistics systems (cumulative)

**Result 3: strengthened national statistical systems enabling the regular production and policy use of innovative statistical products for evidence-based decision-making****Proposed programme plan for 2027**

- 18.68 Innovative user-centred statistical products are essential for strengthening evidence-based policymaking, monitoring national development plans, and advancing progress towards the Sustainable Development Goals and Agenda 2063. Despite improved statistical production, many ECA member States still struggle to transform existing data into timely, accessible and policy-relevant products that meet decision makers' needs. The subprogramme has supported progress by helping countries enhance data dissemination, strengthen producer-user engagement and develop digital platforms for accessing official statistics, including census and survey result trackers, monitoring dashboards, and communication and project management toolkits.

Lessons learned and planned change

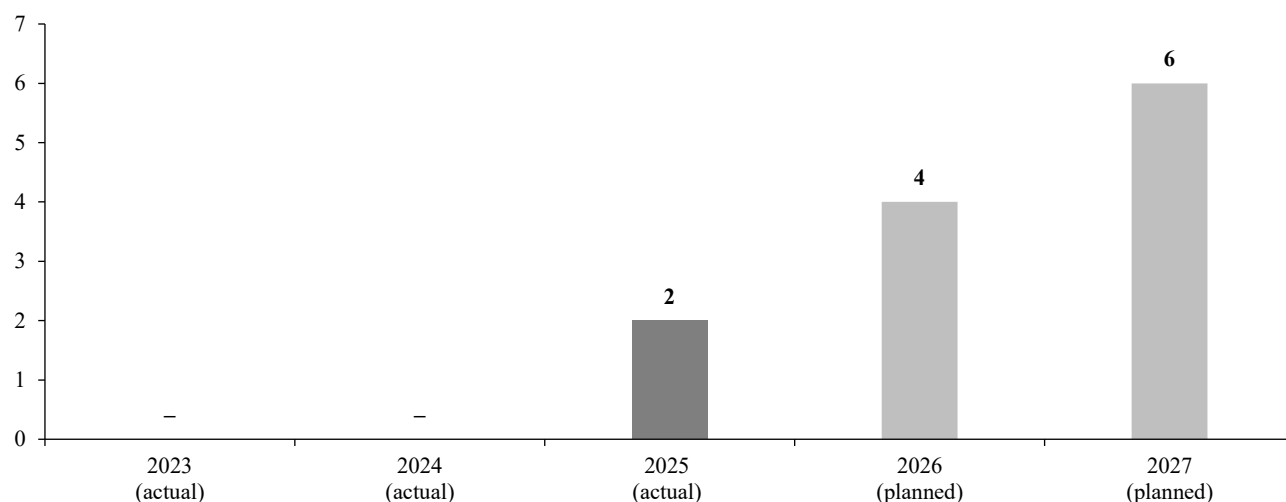
- 18.69 The lesson for the subprogramme was that statistical products have greater policy impact when they respond directly to clearly defined policy questions and are developed through early, continuous engagement with policymakers and other key users. Experience also showed that innovation is sustainable only when countries establish feedback mechanisms and have the capacity to iteratively update products using digital tools. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will strengthen co-creation with policymakers and end users; intensify support for developing digital, interactive

and geospatially enabled statistical products; and help Member States institutionalize feedback systems for continuous improvement. This will enable countries to produce statistical products that remain policy-relevant, widely accessible and regularly used in decision-making processes.

18.70 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.VIII).

Figure 18.VIII

Performance measure: number of statistical products co-developed and in use by members of ECA for policy formulation and monitoring (cumulative)



Deliverables

18.71 Table 18.13 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 18.13

Subprogramme 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	2	7	2
Reports on:				
1. Statistical capacity development, to the Statistical Commission for Africa	—	—	1	—
2. Progress in population and housing censuses, to the Statistical Commission for Africa	—	—	1	—
3. State of a gender perspective and social development statistics, to the Statistical Commission for Africa	—	—	1	—
4. Integration of geospatial and statistical data, to the Statistical Commission for Africa	—	—	1	—
5. Implementation of the 2008 System of National Accounts, to the Statistical Commission for Africa	—	—	1	—
6. Implementation of the experts segment, to the Conference of African Ministers Responsible for Civil Registration	1	1	1	1
7. Geospatial information management, to the Regional Committee of United Nations Global Geospatial Information Management for Africa	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	13	9	15	12
8. Statistical Commission for Africa	—	—	1	—

Part V Regional cooperation for development

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
9. Conference of African Ministers Responsible for Civil Registration	4	–	1	1
10. Regional Committee of United Nations Global Geospatial Information Management for Africa	8	8	12	10
11. Advisory Expert Group on National Accounts	1	1	1	1
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	16	13	19	20
12. On sectoral statistics, including agricultural, health, energy and employment statistics	1	1	2	2
13. On the data warehouse	1	1	1	1
14. On the environmental-economic accounting initiative	1	–	–	–
15. On the development of supply-use tables, intraregional input-output tables and trade-in-value-added model	1	–	1	1
16. On technical assistance on gross domestic product updating and rebasing in members of ECA	1	1	1	1
17. On leading African countries to participate in the global updating and related testing of the 2008 System of National Accounts programme	1	1	1	1
18. On consumer price index data collection, compilation and application	1	1	1	1
19. African programme on a gender perspective and statistics	1	–	1	1
20. African programme on population and housing censuses	1	1	1	1
21. On the development of the African eCRVS Shared Asset	–	–	–	1
22. On the establishment of a digital identity platform for Africa	–	2	–	2
23. On mainstreaming and implementing the United Nations Integrated Geospatial Information Framework and harmonizing with the African Geodetic Reference Frame	2	2	3	2
24. On the Global Strategy to Improve Agricultural and Rural Statistics (second phase)	1	–	–	–
25. Africa Programme on Accelerated Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics Systems	1	1	1	1
26. On the development of a data science campus	1	–	1	–
27. On support for African countries in the implementation of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063	1	1	1	1
28. Fellowship programme for young African scholars to build their capacity in data and statistics	1	1	1	1
29. On the performance data management dashboard	–	–	1	1
30. On census and survey data tools and dissemination	–	–	2	1
31. On innovative statistical products	–	–	–	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	92	61	48	33
32. Workshop on a statistical data exchange system for national statistical offices	5	5	2	1
33. Training events on statistical leadership for heads and senior experts of national statistical offices and line ministries responsible for the production of statistics	5	8	2	–
34. Workshop on modernizing statistical systems in Africa for the leaders and managers of national statistical offices	5	5	2	–
35. Workshop on population and housing censuses and progress on related population and housing censuses for experts and managers of national statistical offices and planning commissions	2	2	2	1
36. Regional workshops on gender statistics for experts in national statistical offices and line ministries	2	2	2	1
37. Workshops on civil registration and vital statistics for experts of national ministries responsible for the production of civil registration and vital statistics data	4	4	2	1
38. Workshop on measuring and monitoring Sustainable Development Goal indicators related to demographic and social statistics for experts in national statistical offices	3	2	–	–
39. Training events on national accounts, environmental and economic statistics and accounting for national statistical offices and ministries of finance	15	15	3	2
40. Regional seminars on the consumer price index, agricultural statistics and energy statistics	20	–	2	1

Section 18 Economic and social development in Africa

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
41. Training workshop on geospatial knowledge infrastructure and fundamental geospatial data sets for monitoring the Sustainable Development Goals	5	5	10	5
42. Workshop on the strategy for the integration of statistical and geospatial information for national mapping agencies and statistical offices	5	5	5	5
43. Training events on the development of national action plans on the United Nations Integrated Geospatial Information Framework for national mapping agencies	5	5	5	5
44. Training events on geospatial knowledge infrastructure with innovative geospatial responses and solutions for a post-pandemic recovery	—	—	5	5
45. Training events on big data and data science for the modernization of the production of economic statistics	5	—	2	1
46. Advisory Expert Group on National Accounts meeting	1	1	1	1
47. Technical workshop on environmental statistics	5	—	—	—
48. Technical workshop on environmental-economic accounting	5	2	3	3
49. Workshops on innovative statistical products for policymaking	—	—	—	1
Publications (number of publications)	3	1	2	2
50. Africa Sustainable Development Report	1	1	1	1
51. African Development Bank Statistics Pocketbook	1	—	—	—
52. Africa Statistics Flash	1	—	1	—
53. On the status of social, economic and natural resource statistics	—	—	—	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	3	2	10	14
54. African regional geospatial databases, online services and geoportals	1	1	1	1
55. African atlas of spatial statistics	—	—	1	1
56. African Statistical Yearbook	1	—	1	1
57. Compendium of Intra-African and Related Foreign Trade Statistics	1	1	1	1
58. Census and survey results issues tracker, monitoring dashboard, communication, dissemination, and project management toolkit	—	—	4	4
59. Automated country data harvester	—	—	1	1
60. Performance data management dashboard	—	—	1	1
61. Mobile statistical platforms	—	—	—	1
62. Artificial intelligence-powered tool for multimodal survey and dissemination	—	—	—	1
63. African data commons for key economic and social data sets	—	—	—	1
64. Artificial intelligence-powered policy tool for food security and trade	—	—	—	1

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: technical advice to members of ECA on civil registration and vital statistics, on the 2030 round of population and housing censuses for members of ECA, on Sustainable Development Goal indicators, on developing integrated geospatial information frameworks at the national and regional levels, and on national self-assessments of readiness for the adoption and use of artificial intelligence.

Databases and substantive digital materials: ECA statistical data portal (ECAStats), providing data for members of ECA; geospatial databases (2), online applications, services and platforms (2); Africa GeoPortal, mobile statistical platforms.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: African Statistics Day; GIS Day; annual Africa Symposium on Statistical Development; dissemination of information through outreach programmes and mobile applications.

Subprogramme 5

Climate change, food security and natural resources

Objective

- 18.72 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to enhance climate resilience, achieve food security, and advance inclusive and sustainable development by harnessing land, natural resources, and the green and blue economies.

Strategy

- 18.73 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Conduct policy research and analysis on:
 - (i) Mineral-led production linkages and the design and implementation of mineral policies, strategies and plans that consider economic, environmental and social aspects and matters related to gender equality, in line with the principles of the Africa Mining Vision;
 - (ii) The circular economy,¹ the development of the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication, including the conduct of voluntary national and local reviews, and the blue economy, in line with the Africa Blue Economy Strategy of the African Union;
 - (iii) Strengthening resilience to climate change and reducing disaster vulnerability of African economies, societies, ecosystems and agrifood systems through integrated implementation of climate action;
 - (iv) Modelling of the economic impacts of climate change to support the implementation of nationally determined contributions;
 - (v) Land governance, including policy and regulatory reforms for land tenure security, in particular for women and young people, and the use of the Framework and Guidelines on Land Policy in Africa and geographic information system-based tools to support decision-making regarding responsible land-based investments by the private sector;
 - (vi) Agriculture and food systems transformation, through financing, insurance and de-risking investment, youth and women entrepreneurship in agriculture, regional value chains, common agro-parks and agro-industrialization;
 - (b) Provide technical assistance and advisory service to member States, the African Union Commission, regional economic communities and intergovernmental organizations to support sustainable development planning and policy formulation under the second 10-year implementation plan of Agenda 2063;
 - (c) Convene peer-learning policy dialogues and regional consensus-building platforms and strengthen African universities and research institutions in knowledge generation in the above-mentioned areas.
- 18.74 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Enhanced African-led knowledge generation, peer-learning and consensus-building processes to advance climate-resilient development pathways;
 - (b) Improved utilization of Africa's mineral endowments to promote inclusive and sustainable development;

¹ United Nations Environment Assembly resolution 5/11.

- (c) Development of policies, strategies and plans to enable the transition to environmentally sustainable economies;
- (d) Strengthened integration of climate resilience and disaster risk reduction approaches in national and regional planning;
- (e) Enhanced implementation by members of ECA of their nationally determined contributions and increased financing in this regard, including from the private sector;
- (f) Improved competitiveness, productivity, value addition and trade in agricultural goods and services;
- (g) Resilient, inclusive and nutrition-oriented food systems;
- (h) Inclusive land-based investments in agriculture and other natural resource sectors, in accordance with the African Union guiding principles for large-scale land-based investments in Africa;
- (i) Improved land tenure security, in accordance with the African Union framework and guidelines on land policy in Africa.

Programme performance in 2025

Members of ECA strengthen policy and institutional frameworks for climate-resilient agricultural value chains

- 18.75 Strengthening regional agricultural value chains and agro-industrial development is critical for improving agricultural productivity, expanding value addition, enhancing market connectivity, and advancing regional trade integration under the African Continental Free Trade Area. For countries such as Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana, where cocoa and rice are strategic commodities, having a coherent and evidence-based framework is essential to guide policy alignment and unlock regionally integrated agricultural growth. In 2025, the subprogramme, through its analytical work and policy advice, and in collaboration with subprogramme 7, component 1, enabled Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana to review and validate a policy framework aimed at strengthening regional agricultural value chains and agro-industrial parks. The two countries reviewed the framework designed to improve agricultural productivity, increase value addition, strengthen market linkages, and promote regional trade integration within the agricultural sector. Through these efforts, Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana aligned their policy and regulatory priorities towards the advancement of regional agricultural value chain development, ensuring that their national commitments reflect African Union guidelines and African Continental Free Trade Area objectives. This has reinforced the strategic conditions for coherent, regionally integrated and investment-ready agricultural value chains, enhancing both countries' ability to drive sustained agricultural transformation and contribute more effectively to broader regional economic integration.
- 18.76 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.14).

Table 18.14
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
The African Union Commission adopted a policy framework to promote sustainable agro-industrial parks development towards enhancing diversification and employment, and promoting intra-Africa trade in agricultural commodities and products	Two countries (Zambia and Zimbabwe) reviewed a policy framework aimed at strengthening regional agricultural value chains and agro-industrial parks, with a focus on improving agricultural productivity, increasing value addition, strengthening market linkages, and promoting regional trade integration	Two countries (Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana) reviewed a policy framework aimed at strengthening regional agricultural value chains and agro-industrial parks with a focus on improving agricultural productivity, increasing value addition, strengthening market linkages, and promoting regional trade integration within the agricultural sector

Planned results for 2027

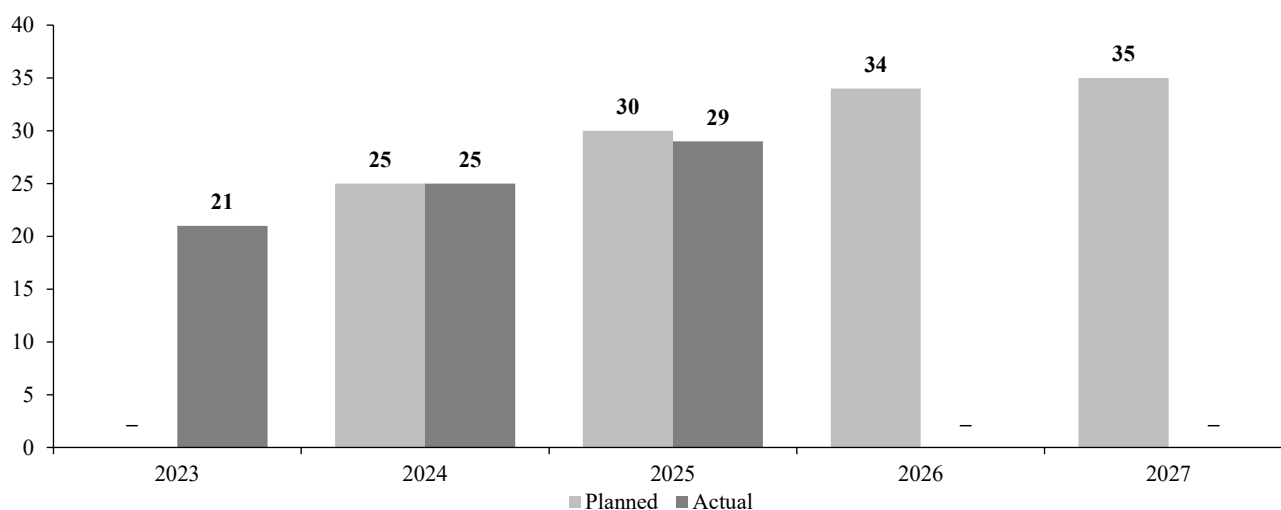
Result 1: members of ECA develop and implement national and regional policy and cooperation frameworks for the sustainable use of natural resources

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.77 The subprogramme's work contributed to the adoption of 4 additional policy frameworks by members of ECA for the sustainable use of natural resources, which did not meet the cumulative planned target of 30 policy frameworks. The target was not met due to ongoing procedural steps required for the adoption of one framework by a regional economic community.
- 18.78 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.IX).

Figure 18.IX

Performance measure: number of policy frameworks adopted by members of ECA for the sustainable use of natural resources (cumulative)



Result 2: resilient and inclusive agrifood systems

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.79 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development of one policy framework by the Intergovernmental Authority on Development to enhance land governance and management, which met the planned target.
- 18.80 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.15).

Table 18.15

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Two members of ECA implemented policies in line with outcomes of the Specialized Technical Committee on Agriculture, Rural Development, Water and Environment of the African Union on the United Nations Food Systems Summit	Two additional members implemented policies in line with the outcomes of the Specialized Technical Committee	The Intergovernmental Authority on Development developed a policy framework to enhance land governance and management	One member of ECA or one regional economic community develops a policy framework on resilient and inclusive agrifood systems	Two additional members of ECA develop a policy framework on resilient and inclusive agrifood systems

Result 3: enhanced climate ambition and climate action in Africa

Proposed programme plan for 2027

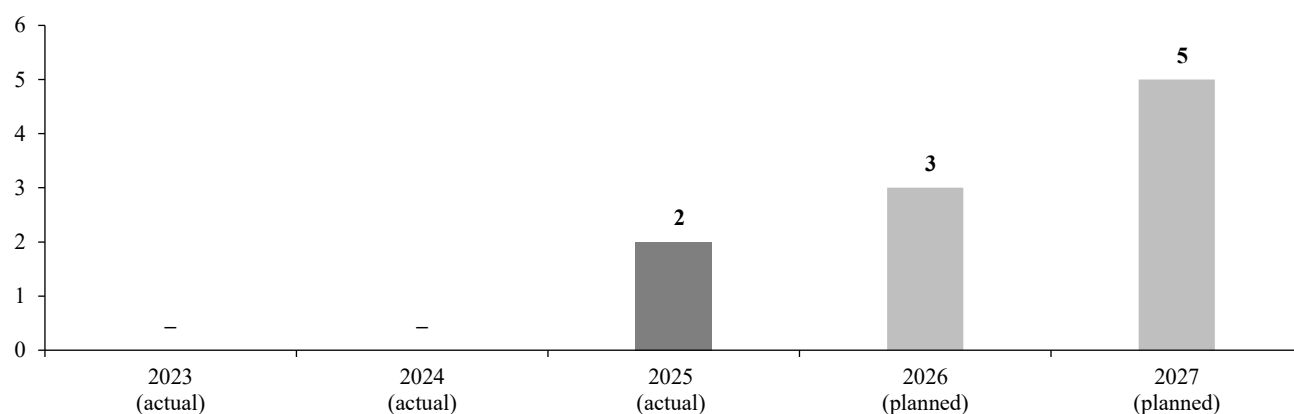
- 18.81 Africa is one of the lowest contributors to greenhouse gas emissions causing climate change, yet key development sectors have already experienced widespread losses and damages attributable to human-induced climate change, including biodiversity loss, water shortages, reduced food production and reduced economic growth. The subprogramme has been supporting countries in strengthening investment, policy, and institutional frameworks to advance climate-resilient development pathways. Its analytical and advisory support has improved national capacity to implement nationally determined contributions, integrate strategies to address the impacts of climate change into national development planning and apply climate-economic modelling in policymaking. It has also supported the creation of carbon markets and regional partnerships that expand knowledge exchange to advance Africa's priorities on adaptation, loss and damage and climate finance under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change process.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.82 The lesson for the subprogramme was that, while regional workshops support peer learning and consensus-building, they are less effective in driving national policy adoption and investment decisions. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will deepen country-level engagement, expand demand-driven technical advisory services and applied climate-economic modelling, and work more closely with United Nations country teams and national institutions, while using regional platforms mainly for peer learning and validation. This will enable members of ECA to develop various institutional instruments such as policies, regulatory frameworks, planning tools, financial mechanisms and coordination platforms that are aligned with Africa's priorities on addressing the impacts of climate change.
- 18.83 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.X).

Figure 18.X

Performance measure: number of institutional instruments developed to promote climate-resilient development pathways and address the impacts of climate change (cumulative)



Deliverables

18.84 Table 18.16 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 18.16

Subprogramme 5: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	3	3	3	3
1. Report on the Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable Development to inform the high-level political forum on sustainable development	1	1	1	1
2. Report to the Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable Development on the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals	1	1	1	1
3. Report to the Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable Development on inclusive green economy policies in the context of structural transformation and sustainable development in the region	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	8	8	8	10
4. Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable Development, in preparation for the high-level political forum on sustainable development	8	8	8	8
5. Committee on Climate Change, Blue Economy, Agriculture and Natural Resource Management	—	—	—	1
6. Conference on Climate Change and Development in Africa in preparation for the African Group of Negotiators' engagement on Africa's common position in the global forums	—	—	—	1
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	12	8	12	3
7. Technical support for selected members of ECA to review and improve their mineral-led local content, policies and legal and regulatory frameworks	1	1	1	1
8. On strengthening the capacity of members of ECA in the development of regional carbon and biodiversity credit markets and green, circular and blue economies to advance inclusive and resource-efficient economic diversification and sustainable development	2	2	2	—

Section 18 Economic and social development in Africa

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
9. Technical support for the Africa Regional Forum on Sustainable Development in the area of the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication and the blue economy in preparation for the high-level political forum on sustainable development	1	1	1	1
10. Fellowship programme for young African scholars to enhance their capacity in policy research, analysis and advocacy in relevant areas	2	–	2	–
11. On climate, land, energy and water strategies	2	–	2	–
12. On regional agricultural value chains and the development of agro-poles in accordance with African Union guidelines	1	1	1	–
13. Technical support for the Conference on Land Policy in Africa	1	1	1	1
14. On supporting women's land tenure security and entrepreneurship through policy, legal and institutional reforms and integrating a gender perspective in land and agriculture	1	1	1	–
15. On regional organizations and institutions of higher learning to enhance skills and knowledge on land, agriculture and food systems	1	1	1	–
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	57	17	60	23
16. On building resilient, inclusive and sustainable food systems in Africa	1	1	1	1
17. Training event on an inclusive, green and sustainable economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication and structural transformation for experts and policymakers	1	1	1	–
18. Training event on climate change and development for decision makers, legislators, parliamentarians, planners, the media, civil society organizations and other communities of practice	2	1	2	6
19. Training event on global climate negotiations to strengthen the capacity of young African climate professionals	5	–	5	2
20. Workshops on climate change, the circular, green and blue economies, land and natural resources in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication	9	5	10	6
21. Workshop on value chains, land, agribusiness, land-based investment and infrastructure	4	–	4	2
22. Workshop on promoting regional value chains and agro-parks in Africa	6	6	6	–
23. Workshop on building resilient, inclusive and sustainable food systems in Africa	3	–	3	3
24. Workshop on decision-support and mapping tools for investing in agrifood systems	9	3	9	2
25. Seminars for agribusiness stakeholders to promote investment in agrifood systems	3	–	3	–
26. Workshop on developing agriculture-related insurance schemes	3	–	3	–
27. Workshop on strengthening land tenure security and entrepreneurship through policy, legal and institutional reforms	6	–	6	–
28. Workshop on the political economy of land governance in Africa	5	–	5	1
29. Regional workshop on voluntary national and local reviews	–	–	1	–
30. Regional workshop for major groups and other stakeholders	–	–	1	–
Publications (number of publications)	12	5	13	9
31. On an inclusive green economy and structural transformation	1	–	1	1
32. On climate change and development in Africa	1	1	1	1
33. On the state of the climate in Africa	1	1	1	1
34. On emerging issues and trends in climate change, the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication, the blue economy and natural resources	3	1	3	–
35. Path to 2030–2063: outlook on resources for the transformation of Africa	1	–	1	–
36. On land, agribusiness, land-based investment and infrastructure	1	1	1	3

Part V Regional cooperation for development

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
37. Africa regional overview of food security and nutrition	1	1	1	1
38. On assessing the potential for policy and legislative reforms to enhance index-based insurance schemes for agriculture in Africa	1	–	1	1
39. On strengthening the case for increased public spending on agrifood systems	1	–	1	–
40. Macroeconomic analysis in support of accelerating agrifood systems transformation	1	–	1	–
41. On harnessing mineral resources for socioeconomic development	–	–	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	21	11	20	10
42. Guidelines related to local policies and strategies aligned with the Africa Mining Vision, including on mineral supply chain development for small and medium-sized enterprises, value addition, empowerment of women and entrepreneurship	1	1	–	–
43. Compendium of climate change experts in Africa	1	1	1	1
44. Mapping of institutions along the climate information services value chain	1	1	1	1
45. On climate change and development in Africa	5	3	5	2
46. On the implementation of climate research for development platforms in Africa	1	–	1	1
47. Quality analysis of climate information for a development policy, decision support and management practice programme	1	–	1	1
48. On infrastructure and capacity for climate information services projects	1	–	1	–
49. On strengthening climate governance and policy implementation	1	1	1	1
50. Africa climate resource platform and information service	1	–	1	1
51. Documentation for meetings of the African Union and the African Union Development Agency in the areas of new technologies and innovation, the environment and natural resources, the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication and climate change in the context of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063	1	1	1	–
52. Tools and methods for country natural capital accounts and managing investments in the blue economy	1	1	1	–
53. On land, agribusiness, land-based investment and infrastructure	2	–	2	1
54. Toolkit for participatory mapping of land tenure systems for inclusive land-based investment opportunities for agriculture and agribusiness in Africa	1	1	1	–
55. On national action plans for the development of agro-poles	1	–	1	–
56. Guidelines for developing viable agricultural insurance programmes	1	–	1	1
57. Guidelines for strengthening women land tenure security in Africa	1	1	1	–

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services to three members of ECA and two regional and subregional cooperation groups on the green and blue economies, climate resilience, mineral-based development, land governance and agricultural transformation, on promoting agriculture-related insurance schemes to build resilience against climatic shocks and on developing frameworks for viable land taxation for enhanced domestic resource mobilization by members of ECA.

D. Communication deliverables

External and media relations: press releases, podcasts and videos related to the issuance of major publications and events.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: websites, social media and platforms on the environment; social media posts for each major event, workshop, publication and policy brief; interactive map on large-scale land-based investments.

Subprogramme 6

Economic empowerment of women and youth

Objective

- 18.85 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to achieve the economic empowerment of women and youth in Africa, by strengthening the design and implementation of policies and programmes by members of ECA, in line with relevant global and regional commitments.

Strategy

- 18.86 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Undertake policy research, provide technical advice, and build capacity on issues relating to the economic empowerment of women and youth, with particular emphasis on financial inclusion, digitalization, education and entrepreneurship;
 - (b) Provide technical support to members of ECA, including national machineries for gender and youth and relevant line ministries, on integrating a gender perspective and youth perspectives into development policies, programmes, frameworks and initiatives across different sectors and thematic areas of interest;
 - (c) In collaboration with partners, roll out relevant equality, inclusion and empowerment indices and provide technical support to members of ECA in measuring progress and reporting on the status of implementation of global and regional commitments on gender equality, youth empowerment and social inclusion;
 - (d) Develop the capacity of women and young entrepreneurs and women- and youth-owned micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises, in the area of digital skills, creative content, financial literacy, e-commerce and the use of digital tools, services and platforms as well as artificial intelligence.
- 18.87 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Strengthened integration of a gender perspective and youth perspectives into planning, budgeting, financing, and implementation of national policies and programmes;
 - (b) Improved understanding of and response by policymakers to global and regional frameworks on gender equality and women's empowerment and empowerment of youth, for the alignment of national development outcomes and the fulfilment of national commitments;
 - (c) Increased opportunities for inclusion, greater economic empowerment and improved livelihoods for women and youth across Africa, through policies and tools designed to address existing and emerging barriers and inequalities;
 - (d) Enhanced digital, financial and commercial access for women and youth by strengthening technological and fiscal policy frameworks and entrepreneurial ecosystems to promote their participation and economic empowerment.

Programme performance in 2025

Strengthened data collection, monitoring and reporting on gender equality and the empowerment of women

- 18.88 Significant gaps in the collection of sex-disaggregated data and gender statistics across Africa limit the ability of member States to effectively track progress towards national, regional and global commitments on gender equality and women's empowerment. Coordination challenges between statistical offices, line ministries, and gender machineries further constrain the collection, integration and analysis of such data, undermining evidence-based policymaking and accountability. The

Minimum Set of Gender Indicators for Africa provides guidance on the prioritization of indicators to be collected in Africa, acts as an important resource for the development of their own statistical frameworks and facilitates the harmonization of regional and sub-regional data collection. The subprogramme strengthened national capacities in Burundi and South Sudan for the collection of gender statistics. Through targeted technical assistance, capacity-building initiatives, and stakeholder consultations, these member States assessed their monitoring and reporting systems, identified key gaps to guide improvements and adopted the Minimum Set of Gender Indicators for Africa. This enabled improved coordination, strengthened data systems, and enabled more systematic, policy-relevant reporting on gender equality and the empowerment of women.

18.89 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.17).

Table 18.17
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
–	Burundi and South Sudan assessed their monitoring and reporting systems and identified key gaps to inform improvements for the collection of data related to gender equality and women's empowerment	Burundi and South Sudan adopted the Minimum Set of Gender Indicators for Africa as part of their national gender equality monitoring frameworks

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: members of ECA integrate a gender perspective into fiscal policy

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.90 The subprogramme's work contributed to three members of ECA (Ethiopia, Kenya and Uganda) establishing working groups with mandates including integrating gender-sensitive budgeting approaches into national planning and budgeting systems, which did not meet the planned target of five member States establishing a mechanism to better integrate a gender perspective into their fiscal policies. The target was not met due to liquidity constraints, which hampered the delivery of planned activities in two additional countries.
- 18.91 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.18).

Table 18.18
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Increased knowledge of members of ECA on the investment needs for achieving Sustainable Development Goal 5	Five members of ECA (Ethiopia, Kenya, Rwanda, Uganda and United Republic of Tanzania) took stock of the institutional mechanisms required for strengthening gender-sensitive fiscal policy	Three members of ECA (Ethiopia, Kenya and Uganda) established a working group along with its terms of reference to integrate gender-sensitive budgeting into national planning and budgeting systems	Three members of ECA integrate a gender perspective into their fiscal strategies	One member of ECA develops a programme to systematically integrate gender-sensitive budgeting into national planning and budgeting systems

Result 2: members of ECA take action to improve the financial inclusion of women

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.92 The subprogramme's work contributed to two members of ECA (the Gambia and Sierra Leone) conducting a situational analysis to identify constraints and opportunities for strengthening women's financial inclusion, which met the planned target.
- 18.93 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.19).

Table 18.19

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	Thirty-four members of ECA enhanced understanding on policies that promote gender equality in financial services African businesswomen increased their awareness of and gained practical guidance on accessing financial services	Two members of ECA (the Gambia and Sierra Leone) conducted a situation analysis to identify constraints on and opportunities for strengthening the financial inclusion of women	Two members of ECA establish a mechanism to enhance the financial inclusion of women, including by integrating financial inclusion into national planning processes	One member of ECA develops a programme to systematically support women's financial inclusion

Result 3: members of ECA leverage digitalization to empower young entrepreneurs

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.94 Disparities in access to digital infrastructure, skills, finance and markets continue to limit the full participation of young entrepreneurs in economic opportunities offered by the digital economy. The subprogramme, through its knowledge products, highlighted the need to strengthen digital skills, ensure inclusive technological policies and foster entrepreneurial innovation among young people.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.95 The lesson for the subprogramme was the need to support members of ECA to collect more data and evidence to support policymaking on the empowerment and entrepreneurship of youth, with particular focus on the digital economy. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will provide technical assistance and capacity-building and promote knowledge-sharing, partnerships and coordination, to ensure that digital transformation translates into meaningful entrepreneurship opportunities for young people and sustainable economic growth.
- 18.96 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.20).

Table 18.20
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	Enhanced capacity of women and young entrepreneurs in South Africa to leverage digital technologies for business growth and innovation	One member of ECA conducts a scoping study to establish a baseline of policies to leverage digitalization for young entrepreneurs	One member of ECA conducts situational analysis to identify priority interventions for enhancing opportunities for young entrepreneurs through the digital economy

Deliverables

18.97 Table 18.21 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 18.21
Subprogramme 6: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	3	3	–	2
1. Report to the Committee on Social Policy, Poverty and Gender on the work of the subprogramme	2	2	–	1
2. Final outcome report of the Committee on Social Policy, Poverty and Gender	1	1	–	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	1	1	–	1
3. Biennial session of the Committee on Social Policy, Poverty and Gender	1	1	–	1
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	3	2	2	2
4. On mainstreaming a gender perspective in national plans, policies and programmes in countries that request technical advisory services	1	1	–	–
5. On supporting members of ECA in using the subprogramme's measurement tools to report on their gender equality commitments	1	1	–	–
6. On supporting members of ECA in integrating a gender perspective into fiscal policy	1	–	1	1
7. On supporting members of ECA in developing gender- and/or youth-sensitive financial regulatory frameworks	–	–	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	10	8	20	8
8. Workshop on the African Women's Report	2	2	2	2
9. Training event on the African Gender and Development Index	4	4	4	–
10. Workshop on integrating a gender perspective into fiscal policy	2	–	2	2
11. Regional knowledge-sharing forum to disseminate good practices in institutionalizing women's and youth financial inclusion within policy processes	–	–	–	2
12. Customized capacity-building event for members of ECA on sectoral policies	2	2	4	2
13. Validation workshop on the financial inclusion situation analysis reports	–	–	4	–
14. Dissemination workshops on the findings of financial inclusion situation analysis	–	–	4	–
Publications (number of publications)	2	–	–	1
15. African Women's Report based on thematic and topical issues	1	–	–	–

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
16. Synthesis report on the 30-year review of the implementation of the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action in Africa	1	–	–	–
17. Knowledge product on financial inclusion	–	–	–	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	2	3	2	2
18. Technical notes on the Africa Gender Index and the African Gender and Development Index	–	1	–	–
19. On climate change and gender equality and women's empowerment in Africa	–	1	–	–
20. Policy briefs and notes on gaps in and opportunities for integrating a gender and/or youth perspective into fiscal policy and financial regulatory frameworks	1	–	2	–
21. Document results, lessons learned and case studies to inform replication of best practices across other member States	–	–	–	1
22. Policy brief on integrating a gender perspective into relevant sectoral policies	1	1	–	–
23. Situational analysis identifying evidence-based entry points and priority interventions for enhancing inclusive digitalization for women and youth	–	–	–	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: one special event on International Women's Day (2027) and the 16 Days of Activism against Gender-based Violence campaign.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: the subprogramme's knowledge platform accessed by at least 100 experts.				
External and media relations: press releases relating to events hosted by the subprogramme.				

Subprogramme 7

Subregional activities for development

Component 1

Subregional activities in North Africa

Objective

- 18.98 The objective, to which this component contributes, is to advance inclusive growth and sustainable development in North Africa through strengthened economic diversification, fiscal management, development finance, regional integration and a better recognition of migrant workers' economic contributions.

Strategy

- 18.99 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- (a) Develop evidence-based policies, strategies and reforms and provide technical assistance related to economic diversification, the implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area and development of resilient and inclusive economies, in partnership with ministries of trade and the African Union;
 - (b) Provide advisory services and hold subregional consultations on the mobilization of domestic resources, fiscal and debt management and sustainable finance;
 - (c) Provide technical assistance, advisory services and training for selected African countries on analysis, evidence-based policy formulation and developing adequate frameworks to mainstream and better leverage diasporas' economic contributions;
 - (d) Conduct research on challenges facing middle-income countries in North Africa, in particular those relating to development and climate finance, human capital and employment creation in

North Africa, with a focus on strategic areas such as digitalization and the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication.

18.100 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Adoption of evidence-based macroeconomic policies and structural reforms by members of ECA to improve debt management and fiscal space and enhance domestic resource mobilization, redirecting resource allocations towards sectors that have a high potential for inclusive and sustainable development;
- (b) Policies and strategies that foster regional integration, enhance productivity and create new jobs in higher-skilled and sustainable sectors;
- (c) Development of evidence-based policies and actions by members of ECA that leverage the contributions of diasporas to sustainable development.

Programme performance in 2025

Members of ECA take action to increase sustainable finance

18.101 Africa faces mounting external debt and escalating debt service obligations that are increasingly crowding out resources for essential public services and investments. The component contributed to strengthening the capacity of African countries to advance sustainable finance practices. Through a regional advocacy platform, the component promoted regional peer learning and policy dialogue for 12 African countries by presenting their experiences and exchanging best practices on how to leverage innovative financing instruments such as green bonds, sustainability-linked bonds, and debt-for-purpose swaps. At the national level, the component contributed to enhancing public debt management through sustained advisory services, technical assistance and capacity-building programmes. These efforts led to the establishment of a Climate Finance Unit within the Public Debt Management Division in Sierra Leone in 2024, to mobilize and manage climate finance for sustainable national growth; and to the development, in 2025, of a national medium-term debt strategy in Egypt, which aims to reduce the country's debt reliance. The strategy was adopted in January 2026.

18.102 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.22).

Table 18.22

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
–	Sierra Leone established a Climate Finance Unit within the Public Debt Management Office	Egypt developed a medium-term debt strategy (2026–2029)

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: members of ECA mobilize finance for sustainable development

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.103 The component's work contributed to the introduction and initial operationalization of an electronic taxation system in Libya, which met the planned target.
- 18.104 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.23).

Table 18.23

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Libya adopted tax collection principles and practices that led to a 60 per cent increase in revenues from stamp duties	Egypt implemented measures to reduce tax evasion and illicit financial outflows	Libya introduced an electronic taxation system	One country generates tax revenues from newly established taxpayer offices	One country develops measures to enhance debt management

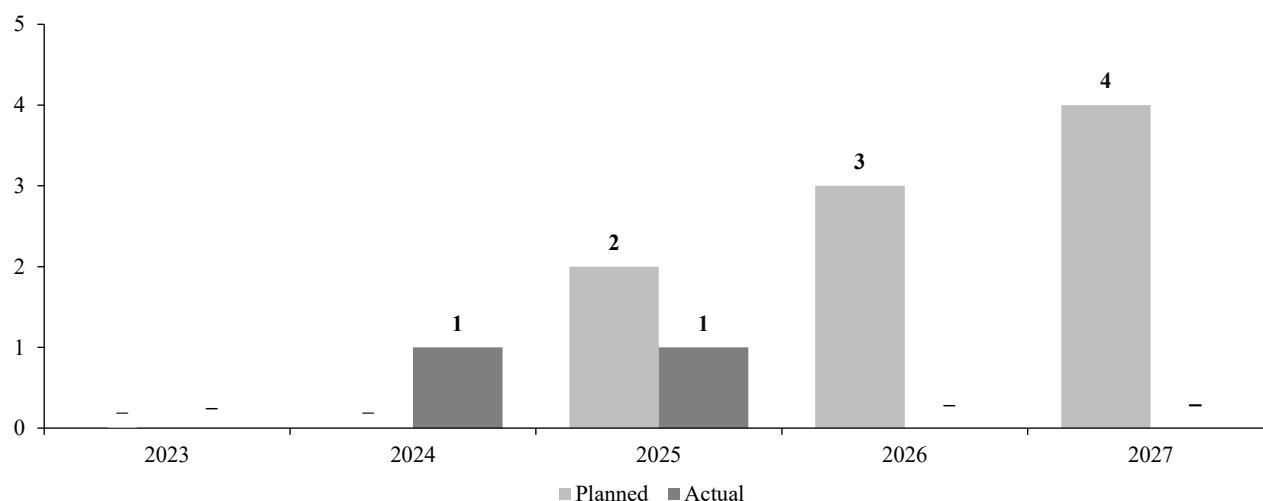
Result 2: members of ECA accelerate inclusive and sustainable growth through increased productivity, diversification and value addition

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.105 The component's work contributed to increased knowledge materials available to member States on fostering inclusive and sustainable growth through support to small and medium-sized enterprise development, and on overcoming the "middle-income trap", which did not meet the planned target of one additional policy measure adopted to promote productivity, diversification and value addition. The target was not met due to the need for additional time for the member State to develop and adopt such a policy measure.
- 18.106 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XI).

Figure 18.XI

Performance measure: number of policy measures adopted by member States to promote increased productivity, diversification and value addition (cumulative)



Result 3: members of ECA take actions to maximize diaspora engagement as alternative sources of finance for development

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.107 Since the adoption of the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration, members of ECA have intensified efforts to maximize the economic contribution of migration to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals. Since 2024, the component has supported members of ECA in implementing specific objectives (19, 20 and 23) of the Global Compact to develop evidence-based

policies and actions that leverage migrants' economic contributions. The component provided technical support to six members of ECA to formally integrate remittances and migrants' positive contributions into national development plans and to develop adequate actions that help to channel remittances to productive investments and engage the diaspora as development actors. Furthermore, the component has supported members of ECA to better optimize domestic resources and mobilize sustainable finance for development.

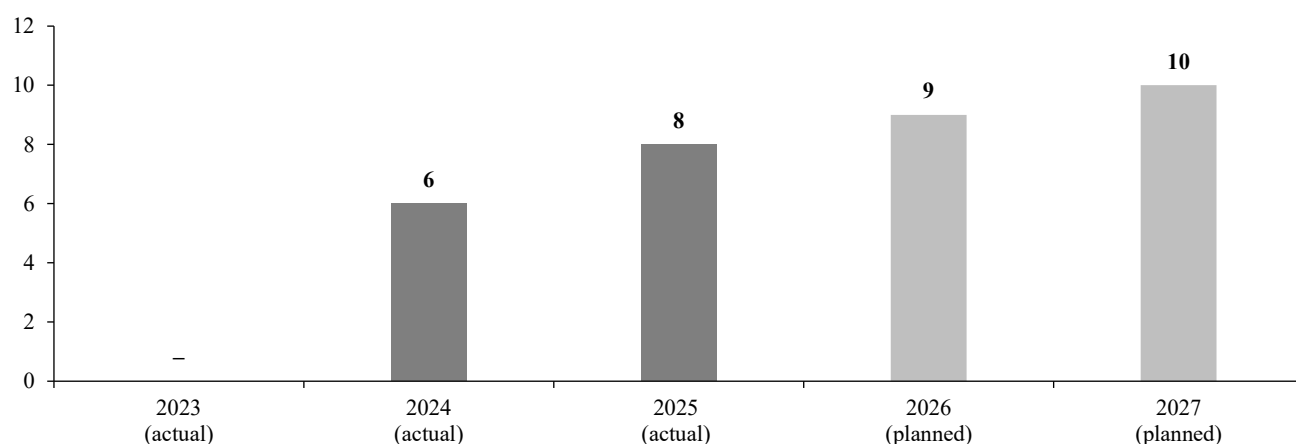
Lessons learned and planned change

18.108 The lesson for the component was the need to further support members of ECA to unlock the potential of the positive contributions of their diaspora, by channelling remittances to investments. In applying the lesson, the component will provide technical assistance and policy advice to support countries in developing tools to maximize the economic contributions of the diaspora, optimize domestic resources and increase sustainable finance for development. In doing so, the component will reinforce internal collaboration with United Nations country teams and international organizations at the country level.

18.109 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XII).

Figure 18.XII

Performance measure: number of tools developed by members of ECA to mobilize alternative source for financing development (cumulative)



Deliverables

18.110 Table 18.24 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 18.24

Subprogramme 7, component 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	4	4	4	4
1. Report to the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for North Africa	1	1	1	1
2. Subregional profile on socioeconomic development in the members of ECA	1	1	1	1
3. Regional and international agendas and other special initiatives in the members of ECA	1	1	1	1
4. Annual report on the work of ECA in North Africa	1	1	1	1

Section 18 Economic and social development in Africa

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>	<i>2027 planned</i>
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	11	11	11	11
5. Session of the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for North Africa	11	11	11	11
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	5	5	4	6
6. On the implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area	1	1	1	1
7. Enhancing the performance of women-led small and medium-sized enterprises by building capabilities in digitalization, export, access to finance and sustainability practices in three countries	1	1	–	–
8. Enhancing small and medium-sized enterprises financing	–	–	–	1
9. On supporting countries in their efforts to formalize the informal sector	–	–	–	1
10. Enhancing tax resource mobilization in North Africa	1	1	1	1
11. Strengthening migration development links in Africa	1	1	1	1
12. Improving debt management in North Africa	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	6	10	5	9
13. Taxation capacity-building training course for one additional North African country	1	1	1	–
14. North Africa Development Forum	1	1	1	–
15. Workshops on leveraging migrants' economic contributions	2	6	2	4
16. Workshop on sustainability transition	–	–	–	1
17. Workshop on the e-mobility regional value chain	1	–	–	–
18. Workshop on climate finance and employment	1	1	–	–
19. Workshop on debt management	–	1	1	4
Publications (number of publications)	3	2	3	4
20. Case studies on the transition of small and medium-sized enterprises to sustainable practices	–	–	–	1
21. Trade, regional integration and inclusive growth	1	–	1	1
22. Policy paper on digital policy framework for small and medium-sized enterprises	–	–	–	1
23. Climate change and employment challenges in North Africa	–	1	–	–
24. Developing financial markets and enhancing the fiscal space	1	–	1	–
25. Challenges facing middle-income countries in North Africa	1	1	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	1	2	2	3
26. On small and medium-sized enterprises and employment	–	–	–	1
27. On migration	1	2	1	1
28. Sustainability transition of the agrifood industry	–	–	–	1
29. On challenges facing middle-income countries in North Africa	–	–	1	–
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultations, advice and advocacy: advisory services to North African members of ECA or regional economic communities on regional integration, diaspora contributions, development finance and the middle-income trap.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: one knowledge management hub; three maintained platforms: content management system, collaborative space and customer relationship management of communities of practice.				
External and media relations: press releases, newsletters, briefings and social media.				

Component 2

Subregional activities in West Africa

Objective

- 18.111 The objective, to which this component contributes, is to advance inclusive development in West Africa by strengthening countries' capacity to integrate challenges related to demographic dynamics into their policies and planning processes and achieve regional integration.

Strategy

- 18.112 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- (a) Provide knowledge, tools and policy recommendations on the acceleration of a demographic transition and related implications for sustainable development and climate resilience, including population dynamics, migration, health and mortality, ageing and living conditions, gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls, youth, and sustainable peace and resilience in West Africa, among others;
 - (b) Engage in high-level policy dialogues and provide technical support and capacity-strengthening to countries on regional integration issues, including the implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area, development planning, and the development of budgeting frameworks that are sensitive to a demographic dividend with special emphasis on the empowerment of women and young people.
- 18.113 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Demographic dividend dimensions mainstreamed in national planning, programming and budgeting processes;
 - (b) Deepened regional economic and monetary integration through the operationalization of Vision 2050 of the Economic Community of West African States;
 - (c) Accelerated implementation of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063 by member States of ECA and regional organizations, including enhanced capacities in development planning;
 - (d) Accelerated implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area in Africa, with women and young people empowered to seize the opportunities of the Agreement.

Programme performance in 2025

Members of ECA in West Africa integrate agricultural value chain analysis into planning frameworks

- 18.114 Developing competitive cross-border value chains is central to Africa's regional integration agenda. By enabling specialization, scale, and value addition across borders, regional agricultural value chains can unlock higher productivity, increase export earnings, catalyse technology and skills transfer, create jobs and improve food security. In 2023, the component supported countries to conduct regional integration impact assessments, which enabled them to identify priority regional value chains to be promoted. In 2024, the component organized a training series for national experts on trade facilitation and regional integration, including integrating agriculture value chain analysis into planning frameworks. In 2025, the component, in collaboration with subprogramme 5, provided policy advice and technical assistance to Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana to identify policy, regulatory and institutional reforms needed to strengthen regional value chains integration under the African Continental Free Trade Area. It provided policymakers with evidence-based recommendations to reduce post-harvest losses, improve logistics and customs management, and enhance cross-border

cooperation. Through this support, cross-border value chain analysis was integrated into national development planning processes of both countries.

18.115 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.25).

Table 18.25

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
15 Member States participated in regional integration impact assessments	Approximately 150 national and regional experts from 15 countries in West Africa strengthened their knowledge and capacities on trade facilitation and regional value chains	Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana integrated cross-border value chain analysis into national development planning processes

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: members of ECA assess debt sustainability and develop longer-term fiscal strategies

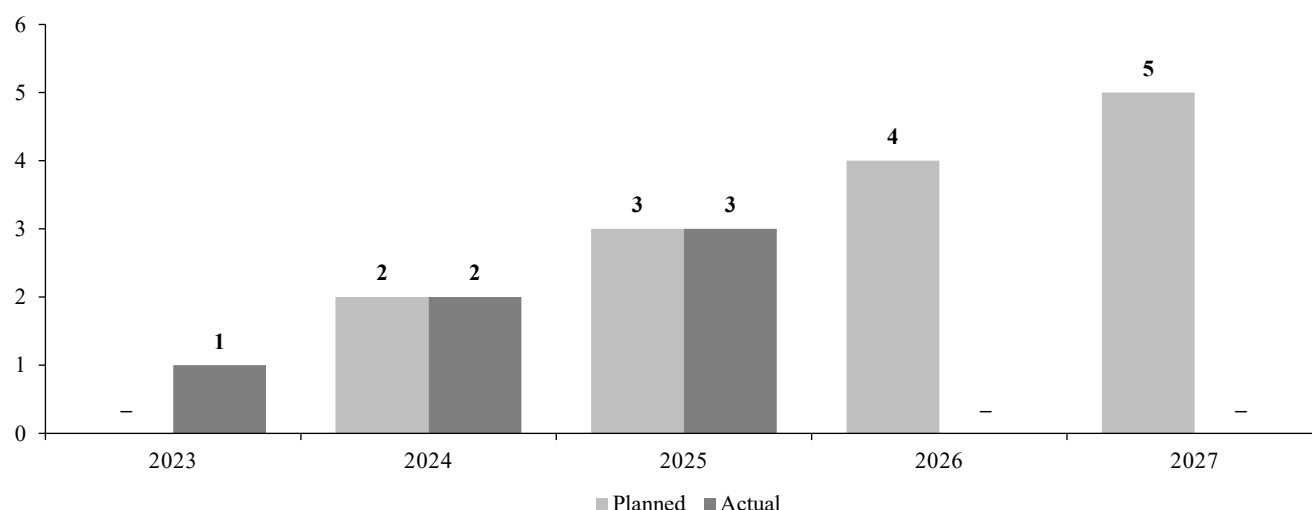
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

18.116 The component's work contributed to one additional member of ECA (Sierra Leone) developing long-term fiscal strategies to address debt, including digitalization of the taxation system through the introduction of the Integrated Tax Administration System by the National Revenue Authority, as well as the development of a strategic road map to handle transfer pricing, which met the planned target. The implementation of the strategic road map led to the adoption, in 2026, of the Finance Act 2026, which introduced new regulations related to transfer pricing.

18.117 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XIII).

Figure 18.XIII

Performance measure: number of members of ECA developing longer-term fiscal strategies to address debt (cumulative)



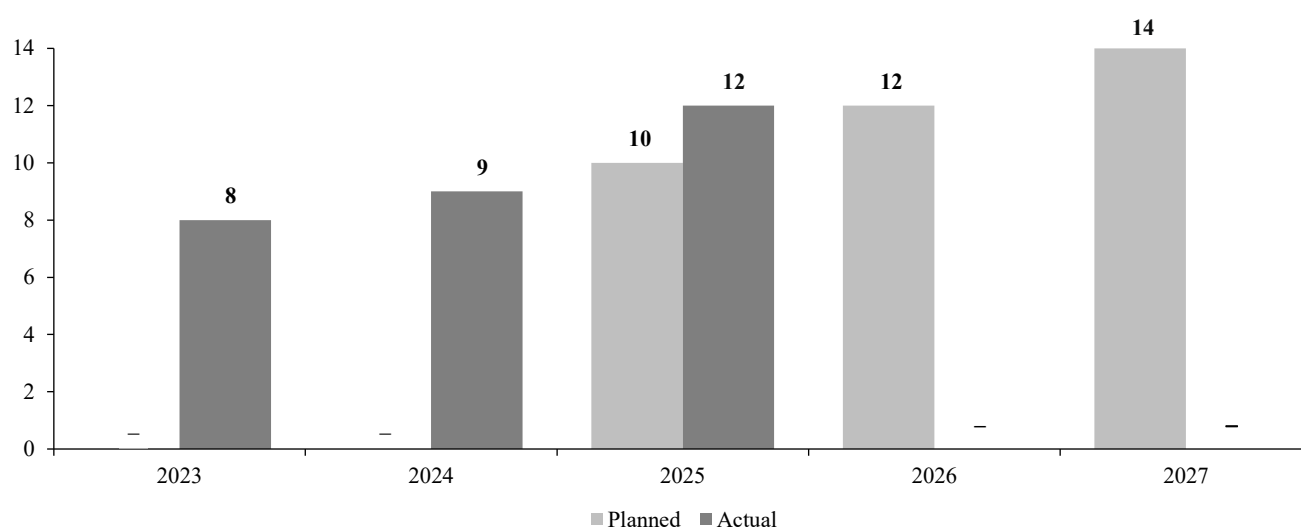
Result 2: increased operationalization of national African Continental Free Trade Area strategies

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.118 The component's work contributed to three additional members of ECA (Cabo Verde, Ghana and Liberia) implementing priority areas of their national African Continental Free Trade Area strategies, which exceeded the cumulative planned target of 10 countries.
- 18.119 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XIV).

Figure 18.XIV

Performance measure: number of West African countries that have implemented priority areas of their national African Continental Free Trade Area strategies (cumulative)



Result 3: enhanced national budgeting and monitoring systems to harness the demographic dividend

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.120 Harnessing the demographic dividend remains essential for strengthening sustainable development outcomes across members of ECA, as it links population dynamics to evidence-based planning and budgeting. The subprogramme has supported countries in applying the Budgeting Sensitive to the Demographic Dividend approach and related tools, building national capacities to integrate demographic considerations into planning and expenditure frameworks, and contributing to progress towards more demographic-dividend-responsive policies and budget processes.

Lessons learned and planned change

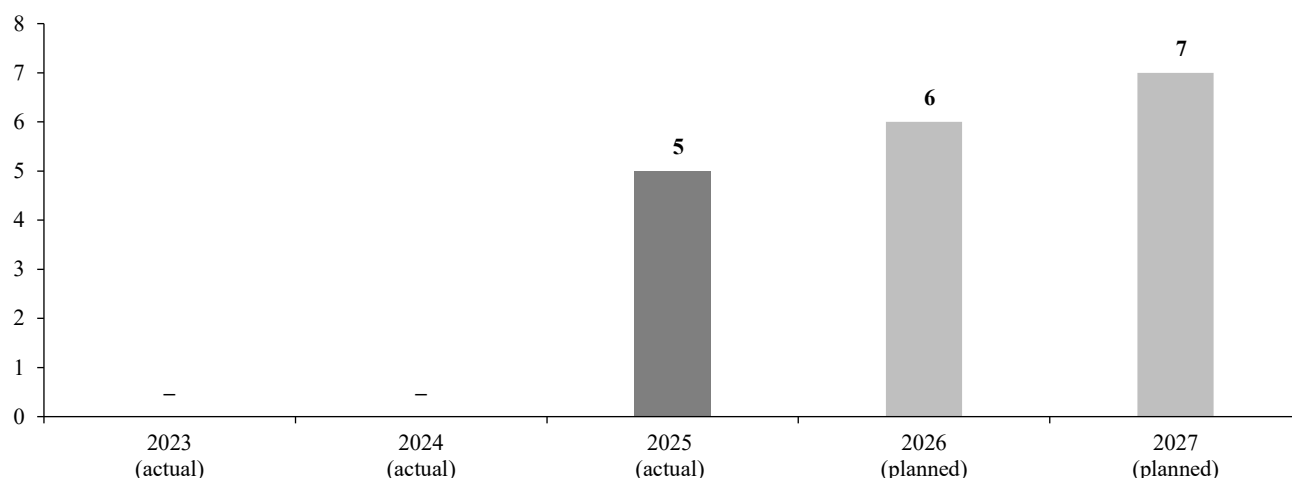
- 18.121 The lesson for the component was that progress achieved through technical support is difficult to sustain in contexts affected by political instability and high staff turnover, which weaken institutional memory and disrupt the consistent application of reforms related to budgeting sensitive to the demographic dividend. In applying this lesson, the subprogramme will adopt a more continuous and system-focused approach by strengthening the operationalization of budgeting sensitive to the demographic dividend through a regional pool of multidisciplinary experts to ensure ongoing technical guidance, knowledge transfer, and national ownership. The component will also support the upgrade of budgetary information systems and introduce the application of budget transformation techniques and related automated analysis. In addition, the component will further enhance the

regional digital monitoring platform to improve the sustainability and efficiency of evidence-based monitoring of progress on the African Union road map on harnessing the demographic dividend.

18.122 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XV).

Figure 18.XV

Performance measure: number of members of ECA that have operationalized budgeting and monitoring frameworks for a demographic dividend (cumulative)



Deliverables

18.123 Table 18.26 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 18.26

Subprogramme 7, component 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	2	2	2
1. Report to the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for West Africa on the implementation of the work of ECA in West Africa	1	1	1	1
2. Annual report on progress in the implementation of agreed-upon regional and international development agendas in West Africa	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	16	10	16	8
3. Annual session of the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for West Africa	8	7	8	6
4. Annual meeting of West African intergovernmental organizations	8	3	8	2
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	1	1	1
5. Strengthening the institutional capacity of regional economic communities, intergovernmental organizations, national Governments, national observatories of the demographic dividend and parliaments to capitalize on demographic dynamics for development in West Africa	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops, and training events (number of days)	14	14	14	10
6. Workshops on opportunities and challenges of demographic dynamics and other sustainable issues in West Africa	9	9	9	5

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
7. Training events on strengthening the capacities of members of ECA in demographic economic dynamics for development	5	5	5	5
Publications (number of publications)	3	3	2	2
8. On country and subregional socioeconomic and demographic profiles	2	2	2	2
9. On economic and social structural transformation in West Africa	1	1	–	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	1	1	1	2
10. On sustainable economic and social transformation in West Africa	–	–	–	1
11. On demographic dynamics for development	1	1	1	1

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory support to members of the Economic Community of West African States.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: events for parliamentary networks and events for the launch of flagship reports and related publications.

External and media relations: press releases; quarterly newsletter (*Kakaki News*) and other communication materials to the media.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: West African subregion-specific content for the ECA website.

Library services: exhibition of ECA knowledge products through various channels and information on the ECA main repository.

Component 3 Subregional activities in Central Africa

Objective

- 18.124 The objective, to which this component contributes, is to expand the manufacturing and high-value service sectors and increase the share of tradable and manufactured goods in total exports, deepen regional value chains and improve the competitiveness and productivity of local economies in order to accelerate inclusive and sustainable economic diversification and structural transformation in Central Africa.

Strategy

- 18.125 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- (a) Provide technical assistance and advisory services to members and regional economic communities of ECA in Central Africa on:
 - (i) Formulating and implementing national and subregional development plans and economic diversification strategies with a focus on intra-Central African trade and creating a business climate conducive to employment creation and resilient to external shocks;
 - (ii) Translating their national and regional strategies for the implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area into specific and bankable projects, using market access information and trade opportunity data, with a particular focus on the agricultural, energy and pharmaceutical sectors;
 - (iii) Transforming transport corridors into development corridors, in line with the Central Africa consensual transport plan;
 - (iv) Developing ICT infrastructure and regulatory frameworks required for the digital transition, including support for the establishment of technology innovation centres, in collaboration with the ECA Centre of Excellence on Digital Identity, Trade and Economy within subprogramme 3;

- (v) Harmonizing trade instruments of the Economic Community of Central African States and the Central African Economic and Monetary Community while developing a unified master plan for industrial development and economic diversification in Central Africa;
 - (b) Collaborate with the private sector, subregional think tanks and regional economic communities in the above-mentioned areas;
 - (c) Train members of ECA and United Nations country teams in the use of the ECA integrated planning and reporting toolkits.
- 18.126 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Strengthened regional value chains and industrial clusters, integrated with local economies, and expanded manufacturing and high-value service sectors;
 - (b) Integration of the relevant economic diversification-related goals and targets of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063 into national development strategies and plans, common country assessments and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks;
 - (c) Increased productivity of local firms and economies, including adoption of new technologies;
 - (d) Strengthened role of the private sector in economic diversification in Central Africa.

Programme performance in 2025

Sao Tome and Principe developed and validated its first tourism satellite accounts

- 18.127 Tourism is a vital sector for small island developing States, providing avenues for economic diversification and sustainable and inclusive growth. Tourism satellite accounts provide a standard statistical framework to measure the economic contribution of tourism to a national economy, thereby enhancing planning, policy formulation, and resource mobilization in support of sustainable development. The component supported Sao Tome and Principe to develop and validate its first tourism satellite accounts. The component provided technical assistance and held workshops with national stakeholders on strengthening natural capital accounting, conducting demand- and supply-side analysis, and high-level policy dialogues. These efforts culminated in the validation and official handover of the tourism satellite accounts to the national Government.
- 18.128 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.27).

Table 18.27
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Sao Tome and Principe validated its first tourism satellite accounts, enabling the country to measure the contribution of tourism to its gross domestic product

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: members of ECA develop special economic zones for sustainable and inclusive economic diversification

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.129 The component's work contributed to the completion of pre-feasibility studies for a project on valorization of wood residues from forestry operations in Bertoua and Yokadouma in Cameroon, with a view to developing a new-generation special economic zone, which did not meet the planned target of two member States of ECA concluding pre-feasibility studies. The target was not met due to the political context in targeted countries, where ongoing electoral processes temporarily shifted focus from technical and economic initiatives.
- 18.130 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.28).

Table 18.28

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
Three members of ECA (Cameroon, Congo and Democratic Republic of the Congo) established new-generation special economic zones to promote value addition to their natural resources	Four members of ECA (Cameroon, Congo, Democratic Republic of the Congo and Gabon) assessed the potential of specific value chains to carry the development of new-generation special economic zones	One member of ECA concluded a pre-feasibility study related to the valorization of wood residues from forestry operations	One member of ECA operationalizes a new-generation special economic zone	Two members of ECA conclude strategic partnerships towards financing special economic zones and other clusters

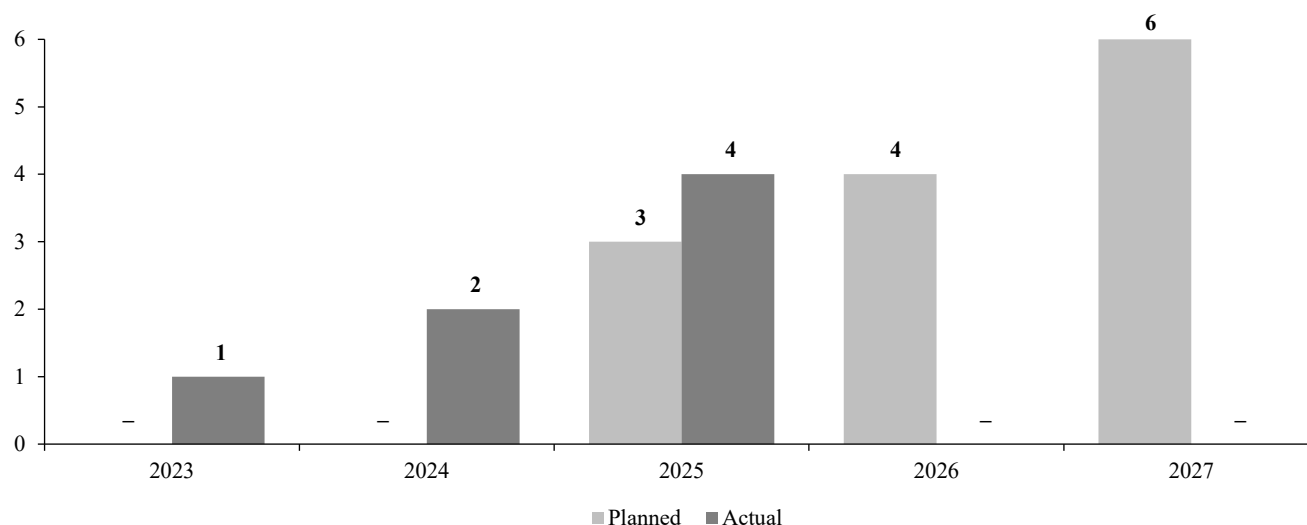
Result 2: Central African members of ECA enhance natural asset valuation and capitalization

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.131 The component's work contributed to two additional countries (Congo and Sao Tome and Principe) being better equipped to independently apply natural capital accounting methods to conduct economic impact assessments of natural assets, for a cumulative total of four countries, which exceeded the cumulative planned target of three countries.
- 18.132 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XVI).

Figure 18.XVI

Performance measure: number of countries better equipped to independently apply natural capital accounting methods to conduct economic impact assessment of natural assets (cumulative)



Result 3: strengthened trade facilitation systems and institutional capacities to accelerate regional economic integration

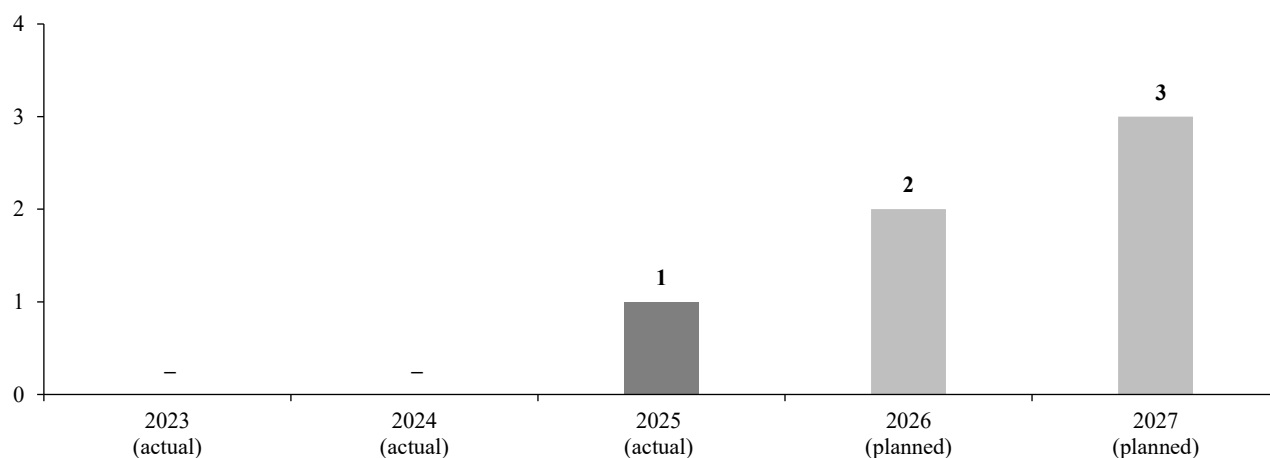
- 18.133 Advancing regional economic integration in Central Africa requires not only the adoption of trade facilitation rules and regional commitments, but also effective institutional arrangements to implement them. While members of ECA have subscribed to regional and continental trade frameworks, implementation remains uneven due to fragmented inter-agency coordination, weakly institutionalized public-private dialogue and the absence of formal governance platforms. The absence of formalized and institutionalized coordination platforms weakens the implementation of trade facilitation measures and constrains meaningful private sector participation in regional integration processes. Experience has shown that, even where national strategies explicitly reference African Continental Free Trade Area implementation and regional value chain development, weak or ad hoc institutional dialogue limits operational follow-through and inter-agency coherence.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.134 The lesson for the component was that continued support is required, focusing on establishing or reinforcing formal national coordination mechanisms with clear mandates, defined membership and regular operating arrangements, to enhance policy coherence, improve inter-agency collaboration and ensure structured engagement with private sector stakeholders. In applying the lesson, the component will support the establishment or formal strengthening of national trade facilitation coordination mechanisms; facilitate structured public-private dialogue platforms aligned with regional integration priorities; promote greater clarity and coordination of mandates among trade, customs, industry and related authorities; and encourage peer learning and exchange of good practices among member States. This institutional focus complements other result areas by strengthening the governance foundations for sustainable regional economic integration.
- 18.135 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XVII).

Figure 18.XVII

Performance measure: number of members of ECA in Central Africa that formalized trade facilitation and coordination mechanisms (cumulative)



Deliverables

18.136 Table 18.29 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 18.29

Subprogramme 7, component 3: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	1	1
1. Annual report on the work of the ECA Subregional Office for Central Africa	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	8	8	8	8
2. Annual session of the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for Central Africa	8	8	8	8
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	1	1	2	2
3. Support programme for trade and economic integration	1	1	2	2
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	36	26	35	32
4. Workshop on economic diversification and Sustainable Development Goal achievement	12	12	10	10
5. Workshop on natural capital accounting	12	14	10	10
6. Training event on trade and market access instruments	–	–	3	2
7. Workshop to support selected countries in the use of data and analytical insights in national planning and policy processes	12	–	12	10
Publications (number of publications)	6	3	8	7
8. Series of reports on benchmarking special economic zones in support of economic diversification, structural transformation, employment, production and society	1	–	2	2
9. Background study on the theme for the annual session of the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for Central Africa	1	1	1	1
10. On the state of economic diversification in Central Africa	1	1	1	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
11. On the economic diversification process in Central Africa: harnessing opportunities for sustainable consumption and production and greenhouse gas emission reduction and economic diversification strategies	–	–	1	1
12. On accelerating the effective implementation of national strategies on the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area: strengthening sustainability and inclusiveness	1	1	1	1
13. On enhancing digital economy integration in Central Africa, emphasizing the role of the fourth industrial revolution and the African Continental Free Trade Area	1	–	1	–
14. On a comprehensive needs assessment of national statistical systems in Central Africa	1	–	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	3	3	3	3
15. Policy briefs on emerging issues in Central Africa	3	3	3	3
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services to and policy dialogues with members of ECA on the African Continental Free Trade Area.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: dissemination of information on economic diversification and on change leadership in at least four member countries of the subregion.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: maintenance of at least seven websites, digital platforms and two communities of practice on economic diversification, industrialization and the Sustainable Development Goals.				

Component 4

Subregional activities in Eastern Africa

Objective

- 18.137 The objective, to which this component contributes, is to achieve deeper regional integration in Eastern Africa by advancing the operationalization of the African Continental Free Trade Area, increasing intraregional investments, harnessing the blue economy and enhancing regional tourism.

Strategy

- 18.138 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- (a) Provide support to countries and regional economic communities, through knowledge production, technical assistance, capacity-building and policy dialogues, on the development and effective implementation of their national and regional strategies for the implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area, and the negotiation and arrangements concerning outstanding protocols and instruments on the Area;
 - (b) Enable the private sector to take part in operationalizing the African Continental Free Trade Area, through structured capacity-building interventions that include detailed step-by-step guides, practical advisory services, and information sessions on key instruments and protocols;
 - (c) Engage in policy dialogue and provide training to promote transboundary investments and cost-effective trade logistics, including the creation and use of digital platforms and commodity exchanges to reduce asymmetries of information;
 - (d) Foster the development of regional value chains in food and agriculture through value chain analyses and the dissemination of information to public and private sector stakeholders about investment opportunities;
 - (e) Support members of ECA to assess the socioeconomic potential of the blue economy and conduct market analyses for small and medium-sized enterprises, while keeping in mind the

- need to protect natural resources, and to operationalize, at the national level, the Africa Blue Economy Strategy and related strategies of regional economic communities;
- (f) Support members of ECA in the development of national tourism strategies, in line with the recommendations set out in the African tourism strategy, and provide training on the production of high-quality tourism statistics in the subregion.
- 18.139 The above-mentioned work will help members of ECA to make progress towards the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 5, 7, 8, 11, 12, 13, 14 and 17.
- 18.140 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) National development planning frameworks incorporating and amplifying blue economy policies and strategies;
 - (b) Standardized methodologies for tourism data collection and analysis in the subregion;
 - (c) Increased market diversification and economic resilience to external shocks, related in particular to the blue economy, the tourism sector and food-related value chains;
 - (d) Deeper regional integration and improved connectivity of landlocked countries;
 - (e) Higher levels of intraregional trade in goods and services;
 - (f) Harmonization of investment regimes and investment promotion strategies, and improved regulatory frameworks governing investment.

Programme performance in 2025

Somalia launches Centennial Vision 2060 and ratifies the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area

- 18.141 The Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area is a landmark agreement to boost intra-African trade and economic integration, while Somalia's Centennial Vision 2060 outlines the country's long-term development aspirations. The component advanced regional integration in Eastern Africa by supporting Somalia's operationalization of the African Continental Free Trade Area and the development of its Centennial Vision 2060. Building on the validation of Somalia's African Continental Free Trade Area National Implementation Strategy in November 2023, the component delivered targeted technical assistance and policy advice throughout 2024 and 2025, towards the alignment of trade priorities with long-term development objectives. These efforts strengthened institutional capacity and consensus on trade reforms, leading to Somalia's historic accession to the East African Community in March 2024, the presidential launch of the Centennial Vision 2060 in June 2025, and the ratification of the Agreement by the Somali parliament in October 2025, providing a transformative framework for sustainable growth and regional integration.
- 18.142 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.30).

Table 18.30
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
The Government of Somalia formulated and validated the national strategy to implement the African Continental Free Trade Area	The Government of Somalia undertook stakeholder meetings and drafted the Centennial Vision 2060 The Government of Somalia acceded to the East African Community	The Government of Somalia endorsed and launched the Centennial Vision 2060 Somalia's parliament ratified the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: members of ECA and regional organizations develop investment promotion strategies

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.143 The component's work contributed to two regional organizations (Central Corridor Transit Transport Facilitation Agency and Northern Corridor Transit and Transport Coordination Authority) developing inland waterways transport strategies aimed at attracting greater investment in regional transport infrastructure, which did not meet the planned target of one ECA member State developing a national investment promotion strategy. The target was not met, as the component's focus was placed on completing regional strategies prior to the initiation of national-level plans.
- 18.144 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.31).

Table 18.31

Performance measure

<i>2023 (actual)</i>	<i>2024 (actual)</i>	<i>2025 (actual)</i>	<i>2026 (planned)</i>	<i>2027 (planned)</i>
Tourism investment guide developed by Burundi	The East African Community adopted the East African Community Blue Economy Strategy and Action Plan	Two regional organizations (Central and Northern Corridor) developed inland waterway transport strategies to attract greater investments	One additional member State develops a national strategy for investment promotion	One additional member State/ regional organization develops a strategy for investment promotion

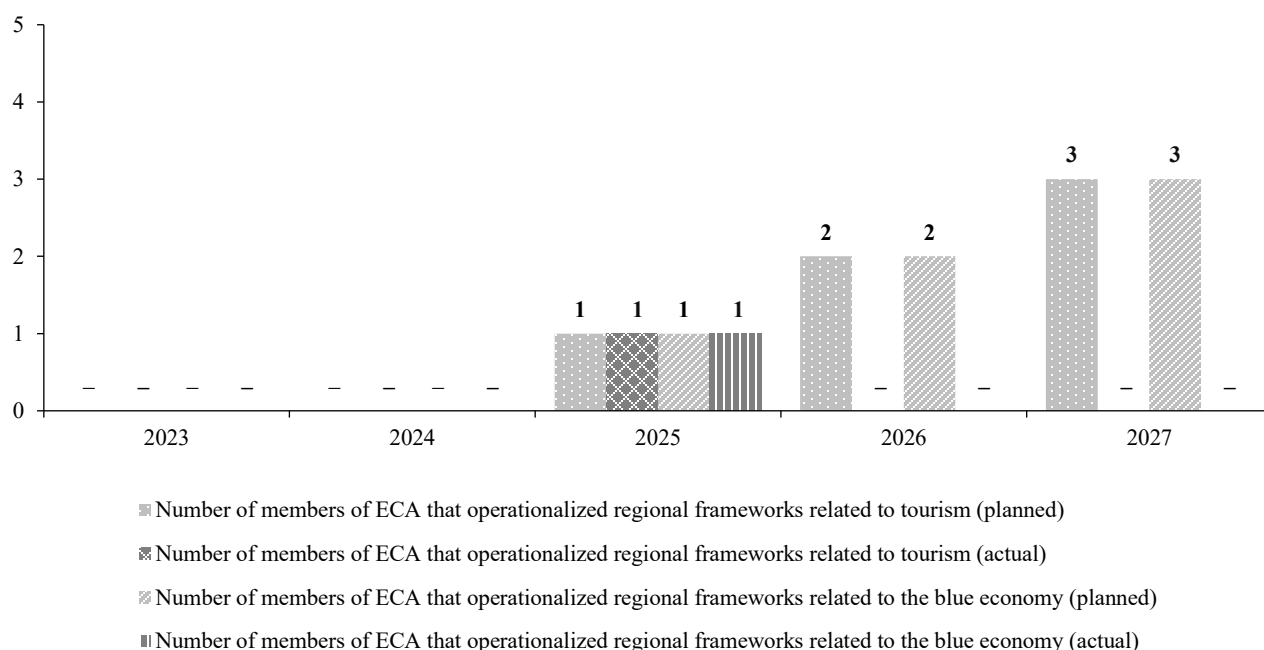
Result 2: members of ECA implement regional frameworks on tourism and the blue economy

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.145 The component's work contributed to one member of ECA (Kenya) operationalizing the regional framework related to tourism, and one member (Rwanda) operationalizing the regional framework related to the blue economy, which met the planned targets.
- 18.146 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XVIII).

Figure 18.XVIII

Performance measure: number of members of ECA that operationalized regional development frameworks related to tourism and the blue economy at the national level (cumulative)



Result 3: strengthened connectivity and infrastructure for deeper regional integration

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.147 Diversified and efficient connectivity is crucial for regional integration and for achieving Sustainable Development Goals 2 and 9. Landlocked countries in Eastern Africa remain dependent on limited corridors and transport modes, increasing costs and vulnerability to disruptions. To lay the foundation for integrated connectivity and trade systems, the component supported member States in Eastern Africa to develop inland waterways strategies, harmonize regional policies for inland waterway transport, and promote digital trade initiatives to improve food security.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.148 The lesson for the component was that support for the development of regional strategies alone are insufficient. For such strategies to translate into tangible impacts, support to facilitate practical coordination and harmonized approaches is required. In applying the lesson, the component will support member States and subregional organizations to strengthen policy frameworks and enhance coordination to promote connectivity. In addition, the component will promote the use of digital platforms, such as e-commerce platforms, with a view to enhancing trade efficiency.
- 18.149 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.32).

Table 18.32
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	Initial comparative analysis of inland waterway transport systems in Eastern Africa undertaken	Nine members of ECA validated a regional road map designed to align inland waterway policies and improve connectivity across the region	Two members of ECA develop or use existing tools to improve connectivity and infrastructure linkages for regional integration	One additional member of ECA develops or uses existing tools to improve connectivity and infrastructure linkages for regional integration.

Deliverables

18.150 Table 18.33 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 18.33
Subprogramme 7, component 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	2	2	2	2
1. Annual report on progress in the implementation of the agreed-upon regional and international development agenda in Eastern Africa	1	1	1	–
2. Report to the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for Eastern Africa on the implementation of ECA work in Eastern Africa	1	1	1	1
3. Background document to the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for Eastern Africa	–	–	–	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	8	8	8	4
4. Session of the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for Eastern Africa	8	8	8	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	2	2	2	3
5. On tourism and the blue economy in Eastern Africa	–	–	1	–
6. On urban tourism and the blue economy in Eastern Africa	1	1	–	–
7. Fellowship programme for young African economists to build their capacity in the area of regional integration and trade	1	1	1	1
8. On trade and/or regional integration	–	–	–	1
9. On tourism and/or the blue economy	–	–	–	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	22	40	19	19
10. Seminars and workshops on regional integration, trade, investment and the African Continental Free Trade Area in Eastern Africa	4	5	4	7
11. Workshops on trade, investment, competition, gender equality and women's empowerment and e-commerce in Eastern Africa	2	3	2	–
12. Workshops on commodity exchanges, deepening of regional value chains and role of trade corridors to foster operationalization of the African Continental Free Trade Area in Eastern Africa	2	2	2	2
13. Workshops on access to financing investments: financial technology and the role of cryptocurrencies for regional investment	1	–	–	–
14. Workshop on e-commerce opportunities and challenges in Eastern Africa	1	3	1	–

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
15. Workshop on blue economy policy and strategy in Eastern Africa	6	11	4	–
16. Workshop on tourism policy and strategy in Eastern Africa	6	16	6	–
17. Workshop on advancing the blue economy agenda in Eastern Africa	–	–	–	5
18. Workshop on advancing the tourism agenda in Eastern Africa	–	–	–	5
Publications (number of publications)	5	2	4	4
19. Subregional profile	1	1	1	1
20. On regional integration and operationalization of the African Continental Free Trade Area in Eastern Africa	1	1	1	1
21. On blue economy policy and strategy experiences from Eastern Africa	2	–	1	1
22. On tourism policy and strategy experiences and tourism satellite accounts in Eastern Africa	1	–	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	6	9	4	3
23. On blue economy development in Eastern Africa	2	2	1	1
24. On trade and tourism development in Eastern Africa	2	2	1	1
25. On regional integration and implementation of the African Continental Free Trade Area	2	5	2	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services to seven member States and/or regional organizations on trade, tourism and the blue economy for deeper regional integration.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: distribution of information publications.				
External and media relations: quarterly engagements with national and regional media outlets.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: monthly web-based information bulletins on global outreach.				

Component 5 Subregional activities in Southern Africa

Objective

- 18.151 The objective, to which this component contributes, is to deepen regional integration and strengthen capacities to achieve inclusive industrialization for the reduction of poverty and inequality in Southern Africa.

Strategy

- 18.152 To contribute to the objective, the component will:
- (a) Undertake policy research and analysis on inclusive and sustainable industrialization, value chain development, regional integration and trade, private sector development, and poverty and inequality, provide technical assistance to member States, regional economic communities and intergovernmental organizations and disseminate best practices at the subregional and national levels in Southern Africa;
 - (b) Develop and disseminate policy tools and guidelines for the promotion of trade, inclusive and sustainable industrialization, including value addition, manufacturing and value chain development, at the national and subregional levels in Southern Africa;
 - (c) Support members of ECA in the implementation of Vision 2050 of the Southern African Development Community (SADC) and its regional indicative strategic development plan for 2020–2030, thereby contributing to the achievement of Sustainable Development Goals 1, 8, 9 and 10 and related goals of Agenda 2063;

- (d) Collaborate with partners, including the African Union Southern Africa Regional Office, SADC, the Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA), the African Development Bank, the African Export-Import Bank, the Arab Bank for Economic Development in Africa, private sector associations and research institutions:
 - (i) To strengthen the capacities of members of ECA to advance inclusive and sustainable industrialization and regional integration through implementation of the SADC industrialization strategy and road map (2015–2063), the SADC Regional Energy Access Strategy and Action Plan (2020–2030), the COMESA industrial policy (2015–2030), the African Continental Free Trade Area and the free trade areas of the regional economic communities;
 - (ii) To provide technical support for the development of strategies and guidelines for the integration of considerations related to climate change into industrialization and trade policies in Southern Africa;
- (e) Build the capacities of members of ECA, regional economic communities and the private sector:
 - (i) To address the challenges and opportunities of the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication, and to increase productive capacities, given the situation of energy resource deficiency in the region and the impact of climate change on key sectors;
 - (ii) To address the impact of external shocks, by rolling out initiatives aimed at supporting their recovery and strengthening their resilience to future shocks;
 - (iii) To leverage digitalization, science, technology and innovation to facilitate trade, growth, business development and enhanced productivity and competitiveness.

18.153 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:

- (a) Enhanced implementation of the SADC Vision 2050 and indicative strategic plan, the SADC industrialization strategy and road map and the COMESA industrial policy;
- (b) Economic diversification and transformation through value addition and the development of sustainable regional value chains, accelerated by transboundary industrial clusters, hubs and special economic zones in selected members of ECA;
- (c) Harmonization of national industrial policies with regional industrial frameworks and integration of considerations related to the environment and sustainability;
- (d) Accelerated implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area and the free trade agreements of the regional economic communities, increased intraregional trade in goods and services and enhanced regional integration in Southern Africa;
- (e) Increased resilience and competitiveness of the private sector and micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises and enhanced participation in industry and trade in Southern Africa;
- (f) Evidence-based policy responses related to poverty, inequality and vulnerability situations in Southern Africa through informed analyses of trends and causal factors.

Programme performance in 2025

Accelerated intraregional trade and investment in the SADC region through digital technology

- 18.154 Innovation and technology have potential to enable the private sector, including micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises, to improve their competitiveness and expand their national, regional and international market reach. The component provided technical assistance and advice to the SADC Business Council towards the development of the SADC Online Trade, Investment and Technology Platform, a digital portal focused on facilitating trade, investment and technology utilization for the private sector, and particularly such enterprises, in the SADC region. The Platform, which is hosted

by the SADC Business Council, was developed to enhance the value and quality of trade and investment within the SADC region in a way that contributes to the development of local and regional economies and helps raise living standards. The Platform was officially launched and operationalized in 2025 as a digital tool for use by the private sector, particularly micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises in the subregion, in facilitating networking among importers and exporters; providing access to trade and market information, inputs, business support services, finance and technology; and serving as a gateway to other business portals and to the wider African Continental Free Trade Area market.

18.155 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.34).

Table 18.34
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	The private sector, particularly micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises, have access to the SADC Online Trade, Investment and Technology Platform to network and access trade and market information, business support services, and finance

Planned results for 2027

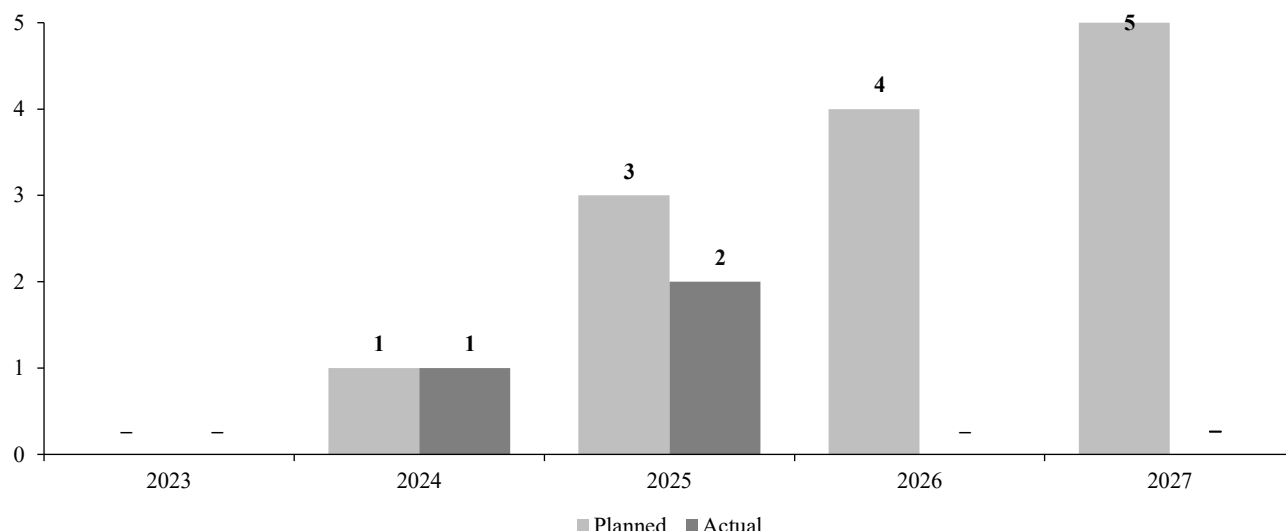
Result 1: accelerating the transition towards more sustainable economies in Southern Africa

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.156 The component's work contributed to one policy intervention, the SADC Just Energy Transition Policy Framework, developed by the regional economic community, which did not meet the planned target of developing two additional policy interventions. The target was not met due to the delay in finalizing interventions and to allow more time for the parties in Southern Africa to conclude negotiations on the outstanding terms of the planned policy intervention.
- 18.157 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XIX).

Figure 18.XIX

Performance measure: number of policy interventions developed by countries and regional economic communities in Southern Africa to support the transition towards more sustainable economies (cumulative)



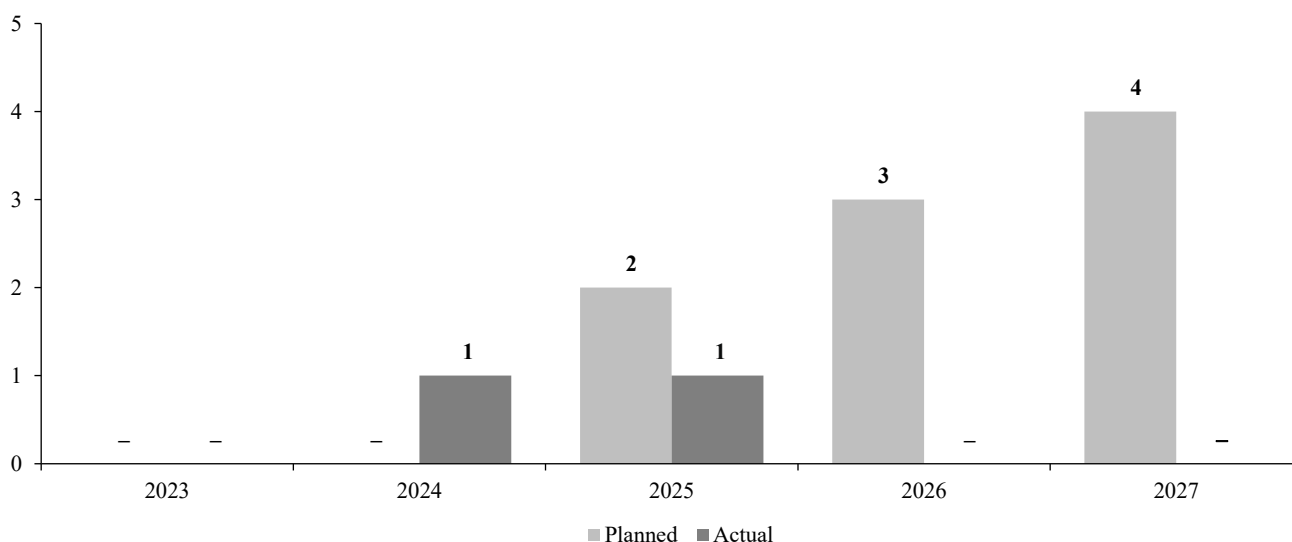
Result 2: inclusive industrialization through value chain development in Southern Africa

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.158 The component's work contributed to initiating engagement with Southern African countries on developing policy frameworks on value chain development, which did not meet the planned target of one additional Southern African country developing a policy framework. The target was not met because the component could not provide planned technical and advisory services or organize planned stakeholder consultative meetings due to liquidity constraints.
- 18.159 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XX).

Figure 18.XX

Performance measure: number of Southern African countries that develop policy frameworks on value chain development (cumulative)



Result 3: accelerated implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area and other trade agreements in Southern Africa

Proposed programme plan for 2027

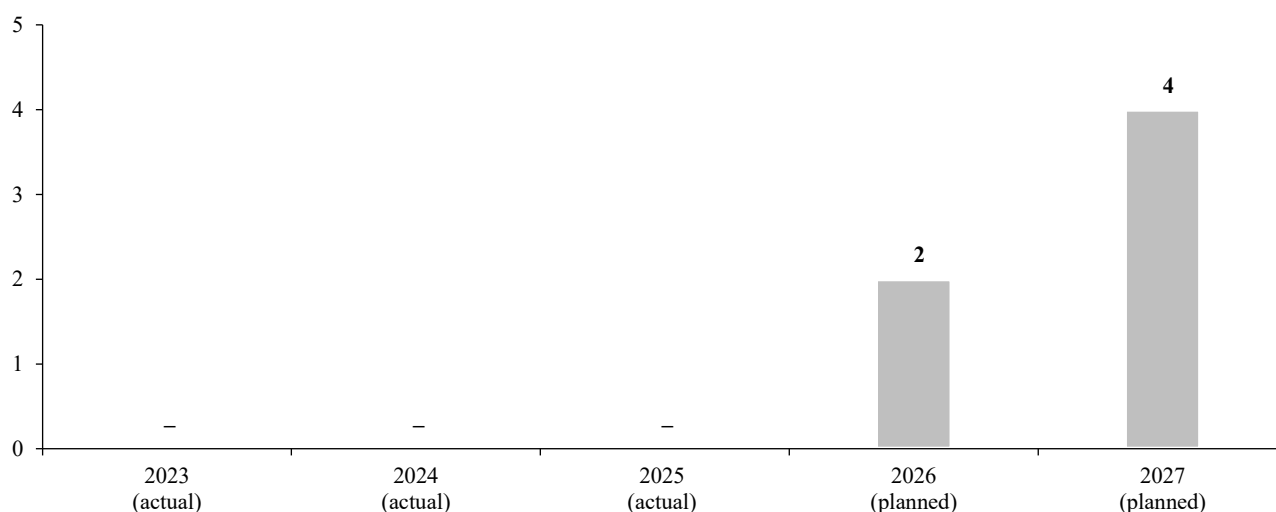
- 18.160 The African Continental Free Trade Area aims to catalyse the structural transformation of African economies by promoting industrialization, trade and regional integration, thereby creating decent jobs and reducing poverty and inequality. The African Continental Free Trade Area has the potential to develop regional value chains and expand market access and investment opportunities for both micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises and large businesses. However, a critical factor for success lies with the effective implementation of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area and other related trade agreements. The component has been providing technical support to countries in developing national African Continental Free Trade Area strategies to guide effective implementation of the Agreement. The component has also produced knowledge products and has delivered capacity-building workshops for micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises on trading under the African Continental Free Trade Area.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.161 The lesson for the component was the need to strengthen the awareness and knowledge of the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area with its related protocols, and other trade agreements, among private sector actors and to address the constraints that limit effective engagement in regional and international trade. In applying the lesson, the component will develop targeted interventions and provide tailored technical support aimed at addressing constraints limiting enterprises, particularly micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises, from participating in regional and international trade. These will focus on improving adherence to non-tariff measures and enhancing such enterprises' capacities to participate in export-oriented regional value chains and to serve as reliable input suppliers to large enterprises.
- 18.162 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XXI).

Figure 18.XXI

Performance measure: number of Southern African countries using trade-enabling tools developed with ECA technical support to facilitate private sector actors to trade under the Agreement Establishing the African Continental Free Trade Area (cumulative)



Deliverables

18.163 Table 18.35 lists all deliverables of the component.

Table 18.35

Subprogramme 7, component 5: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	4	4	4	4
1. Annual report on the work of ECA in Southern Africa	1	1	1	1
2. Report to the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for Southern Africa	1	1	1	1
3. Report on recent economic and social conditions in Southern Africa	1	1	1	1
4. Progress report on regional and international agendas and other special initiatives in Southern Africa	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	8	8	8	8
5. Annual session of the Intergovernmental Committee of Senior Officials and Experts for Southern Africa	8	8	8	8
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	2	2	3	3
6. On industrialization and regional integration in Southern Africa	–	–	–	1
7. On the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty reduction in Southern Africa	1	1	1	–
8. On regional value chain development in Southern Africa	–	–	1	1
9. Fellowship programme for young African economists on inclusive industrialization and regional integration	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	6	6	6	6
10. Training event on regional integration in Southern Africa	–	–	–	2
11. Workshop on economic and social development in Southern Africa	2	2	–	–
12. Training event on inclusive and sustainable industrialization	2	2	2	2
13. Seminar on energy transition in Southern Africa	2	2	2	–
14. Workshop on regional value chain development	–	–	2	2
Publications (number of publications)	3	2	3	3
15. On regional integration in Southern Africa	1	1	1	1
16. On inclusive and sustainable industrialization in Southern Africa	1	–	1	1
17. On poverty and inequality in Southern Africa	–	–	–	–
18. On the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty reduction in Southern Africa	1	1	–	–
19. On regional value chain development in Southern Africa	–	–	1	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	2	1	2	2
20. On industrialization and economic transformation in Southern Africa	1	–	1	1
21. On economic and social development	1	1	1	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services, upon request by members of ECA and regional economic communities, on inclusive industrialization, development of regional value chains and special economic zones, development of the private sector or and micro-, small and medium-sized enterprises, and implementation of the African Continental Free Trade Area Agreement.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: database of economic and social statistics on the 11 members of ECA in Southern Africa.				

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
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D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information material: production and distribution of publications.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: subprogramme's website; content for social media accounts and communities of practice.

Subprogramme 8 Economic development and planning

Objective

- 18.164 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to strengthen the development planning of African countries and to improve their capacity to formulate and manage effective public sector policies for structural transformation and sustainable development.

Strategy

- 18.165 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Deliver training on sectoral, national and regional development and medium- to long-term planning to address the socioeconomic impact of emerging crises, based on updated content on risk-informed economic and social policy formulation and management;
 - (b) Promote peer learning and collaboration among African development planners through communities of practice and broaden access to the digitized knowledge repository of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning;
 - (c) Enhance countries' capacity to monitor and evaluate the implementation of the 2030 Agenda and Agenda 2063, and of national development agendas;
 - (d) Foster knowledge generation, cross-fertilization and knowledge-sharing through research products, fellowship programmes, development seminars and high-level policy dialogues, and also through research networks spanning multiple African countries and bringing together universities, think tanks, United Nations country teams and regional stakeholders;
 - (e) Support the integration of a gender perspective and youth-related issues in all relevant public policies through capacity-building programmes that also consider issues such as social inclusion, entrepreneurship, employment, the green economy in the context of sustainable development and poverty eradication, innovation and digital transformation.
- 18.166 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Increased application by member States of integrated, adaptive and results-oriented policy and implementation frameworks, enabled by strengthened institutional capacities within national public administration systems, in support of effective implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals and Agenda 2063, structural transformation and sustainable development;
 - (b) More effective formulation, management and influencing of public policies by officials and other stakeholders;
 - (c) More inclusive approaches to the formulation of development policies by members of ECA, including through the formulation of macroeconomic and social protection policies.

Programme performance in 2025

Members of ECA move from fragmented to integrated approaches to social protection through the development of national social protection strategies

- 18.167 Across Africa, fragmented social protection schemes have limited countries' ability to effectively reach the most vulnerable. The subprogramme contributed to a major shift towards coherent national systems by strengthening regional capacities and supporting Member States to design integrated, fiscally sustainable and gender-sensitive social protection frameworks. In 2024, the subprogramme developed the curriculum for a bilingual regional course on social protection and the care economy in Africa, which was subsequently reviewed and validated by selected members of ECA. Following this, in 2025, the subprogramme delivered a bilingual regional course on social protection and the care economy in Africa, building the competencies of 1,138 policymakers from 48 members of ECA in system design, fiscal integration, targeting, labour market linkages and gender-sensitive planning. Participants created peer-learning networks that continued beyond the training, fostering cross-country learning and policy uptake. Building on this regional capacity base, the subprogramme provided targeted advisory services that led to the preparation of three draft national social protection strategies for Cameroon, Senegal and Zimbabwe. These strategies propose integrated frameworks to expand coverage for vulnerable groups, strengthen institutional coordination, align social protection with national development plans, embed considerations related to the care economy and ensure fiscal sustainability. Each strategy includes implementation road maps, governance arrangements and monitoring frameworks aligned with national priorities and the Sustainable Development Goals.
- 18.168 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.36).

Table 18.36

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	Select members of ECA participated in and validated the social protection and care economy curriculum	Cameroon, Senegal and Zimbabwe developed draft national social protection strategies

Planned results for 2027

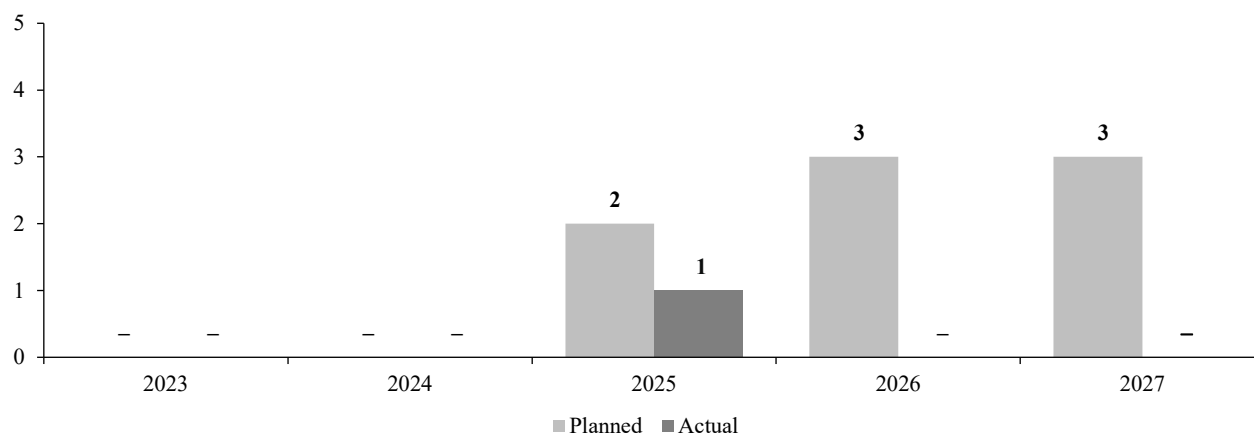
Result 1: members of ECA develop a future-ready workforce

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.169 The subprogramme's work contributed to the establishment of a reskilling and upskilling programme by one member of ECA (Djibouti), which did not meet the planned target of two ECA members. The target was not met due to liquidity constraints which prevented the subprogramme from undertaking in-person advisory support, which limited in-depth engagement of relevant stakeholders and extended timelines for a second member of ECA to establish a reskilling and upskilling programme.
- 18.170 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XXII).

Figure 18.XXII

Performance measure: number of ECA members having established reskilling and upskilling programmes (cumulative)



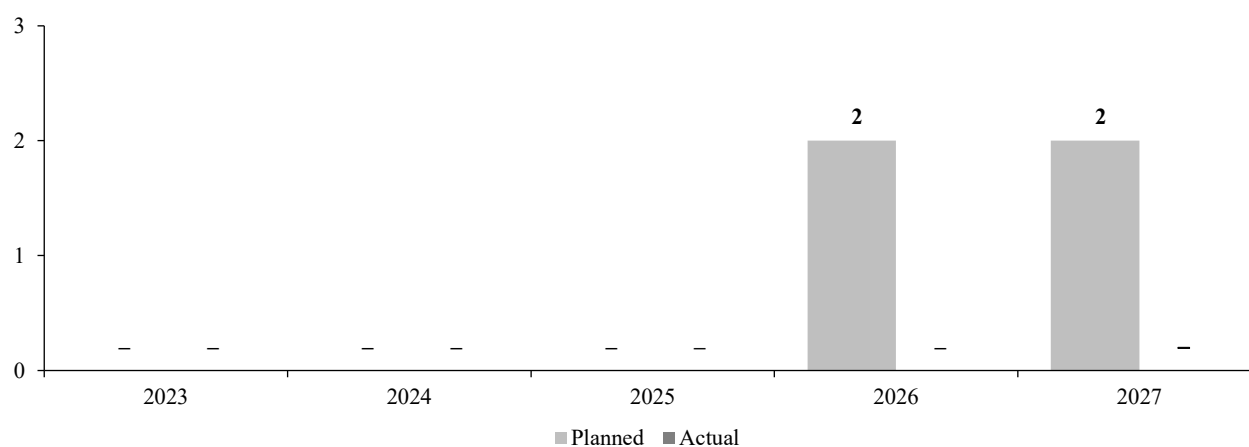
Result 2: strengthened localized development planning and development financing

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 18.171 The subprogramme's work contributed to progress towards the 2026 planned target, through capacity-building for members of ECA and local authorities to improve localized development planning and financing mechanisms.
- 18.172 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XXIII).

Figure 18.XXIII

Performance measure: number of local development initiatives developed by local authorities (annual)



Result 3: improved public administration training systems to enhance national development planning

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.173 Effective implementation of national development plans aligned with regional and global agendas requires strong institutions and skilled public officials. Siloed institutions, fragmented planning and outdated training undermine policy coherence and results. The subprogramme has supported national

public administration training institutions in Djibouti and Sierra Leone to strengthen their training for civil servants.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.174 The lesson for the subprogramme was the need to further support the development of public sector capacity to implement national, regional and global agendas, and that fostering the ability of national public administration training systems to provide such support is essential in this regard. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will support members of ECA to co-design and adopt curricula aligned with national priorities and regional and global frameworks such as Agenda 2063, the 2030 Agenda, the Pact for the Future and the Paris Agreement. This will include technical assistance, training of trainers, peer learning and policy dialogue. Based on experience from Djibouti and Sierra Leone, the subprogramme will sequence its support, focusing first on strengthening governance structures, followed by curriculum reform, with a view to ensuring sustainability.
- 18.175 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.37).

Table 18.37

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	Djibouti developed a capacity-building programme for public administration (2025–2027) for its National Training Institute for Public Administration (INAP)	One member of ECA conducts a management functional review of its national public administration training institution	One member of ECA implements recommendations of its management functional review One national public administration training institution revises its curricula in line with national, regional and global development agendas

Deliverables

- 18.176 Table 18.38 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 18.38

Subprogramme 8: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	1	1
1. Report to the Conference of African Ministers of Finance, Planning and Economic Development and the Committee of Experts of the Economic Commission for Africa	1	1	1	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	3	2	3	2
2. Statutory meetings of the Governing Council of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning	2	1	2	1
3. Meetings of the Technical Advisory Committee of the Governing Council of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning	1	1	1	1

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
Conference and secretariat services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	3	2	3	2
4. Meetings of the Governing Council of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning	2	1	2	1
5. Meetings of the Technical Advisory Committee of the Governing Council of the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning	1	1	1	1
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	42	25	42	23
6. Projects to design and deliver a portfolio of training programmes (in English and French) on development planning and economic management, for senior and executive-level public officials from African countries	40	22	40	20
7. Projects to design and deliver master's degree programmes on industrial policy, development planning and natural resources governance for senior and executive-level public officials from African countries	1	—	1	1
8. Visiting research fellowships for policy researchers and African policy officials on development planning and economic management	1	3	1	2
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	10	9	10	10
9. Seminars on development planning and economic management for African senior policymakers	10	9	10	10
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	2	2
10. On economic management and development planning	2	2	2	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	20	10	20	10
11. On economic management and development planning	20	10	20	10
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services to five members of ECA and three regional economic communities on economic management, development planning and capacity-building.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: two communities of practice for African development planners; online/e-learning courses on integrated planning, digital policy and climate finance.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: information kit for the African Institute for Economic Development and Planning high-level policy dialogues involving policymakers, the private sector and subject-matter experts on issues pertaining to African economic development and planning.				
External outreach and media relations: strategic plan, training brochures, booklets, leaflets, kakemonos, banners and assorted accessories.				
Library services: books, journals and other library materials on economic management and development planning in French and English.				

Subprogramme 9

Poverty and socioeconomic policy

Objective

- 18.177 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to eradicate extreme poverty and reduce multidimensional poverty, by ensuring that members of ECA have evidence-based policies and strategies for social investment and productive job creation.

Strategy

- 18.178 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Develop analytical knowledge, provide technical assistance and promote regional dialogue and learning for members of ECA on designing national social policies and strategies for reducing multidimensional poverty and provision of social protection to the most vulnerable;
 - (b) Generate knowledge, provide technical assistance to members of ECA and organize regional dialogues and learning initiatives on strategies to leverage migration for inclusive development in Africa;
 - (c) Develop analytical knowledge and provide technical assistance to members of ECA in the regional implementation and appraisal of global agreements, including the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration, the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing, 2002, the Programme of Action of the International Conference on Population and Development and the Addis Ababa Declaration on Population and Development in Africa beyond 2014;
 - (d) Enhance knowledge and skills of members of ECA through technical assistance and regional policy learning and dialogues on youth employment to enhance job creation, leverage the demographic dividend and support social cohesion.
- 18.179 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Improved assessment and analysis by member States of poverty, with a focus on multidimensional poverty;
 - (b) Increased prioritization of productive job creation in national development planning, and strategies, policies and programmes, in order to accelerate the eradication of extreme poverty and reduction of multidimensional poverty;
 - (c) Enhanced, evidence-based policy options for the provision of social protection for the most vulnerable;
 - (d) Strengthened responses by members of ECA to address migration, population and development challenges and opportunities, including through youth employment policies and programmes.

Programme performance in 2025

Members of ECA established a common position for Africa on priorities for social development

- 18.180 Africa continues to face persistent social development challenges, including high income inequality and multidimensional poverty, limited access to decent jobs, and gaps in education and human capital development. Addressing these issues is critical to achieving the aspirations of Agenda 2063 and the 2030 Agenda. The World Summit for Social Development provides an important platform for African countries to influence global social development frameworks and ensure that Africa's priorities are reflected in international commitments. The subprogramme, in collaboration with the African Union Commission, conducted an expert group meeting in preparation for the regional review of the Second World Summit for Social Development in September 2025. The meeting provided a platform for African experts, policymakers, and practitioners to deliberate upon and consolidate Africa's perspectives and priorities, and to ensure that these were reflected in the global deliberations at the Second World Summit for Social Development. During the discussion, social development challenges in Africa were examined and consensus emerged around three interlinked priorities: (a) reduction of poverty and inequality; (b) promotion of decent jobs and youth employment; and (c) strengthening education and human capital development, which together form the foundation for inclusive and sustainable development across the continent. Participants highlighted concrete pathways for reform, calling for stronger institutions, better financing, and the deliberate inclusion of youth, women and the most vulnerable in policy design and delivery. The meeting led to the development of a common

African position on social development priorities, which was adopted by members of ECA and guided their engagement at the Second World Summit for Social Development.

18.181 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.39).

Table 18.39

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
—	—	Members of ECA adopted a common African position on social development at the Second World Summit for Social Development

Planned results for 2027

Result 1: improved social protection systems for the most vulnerable

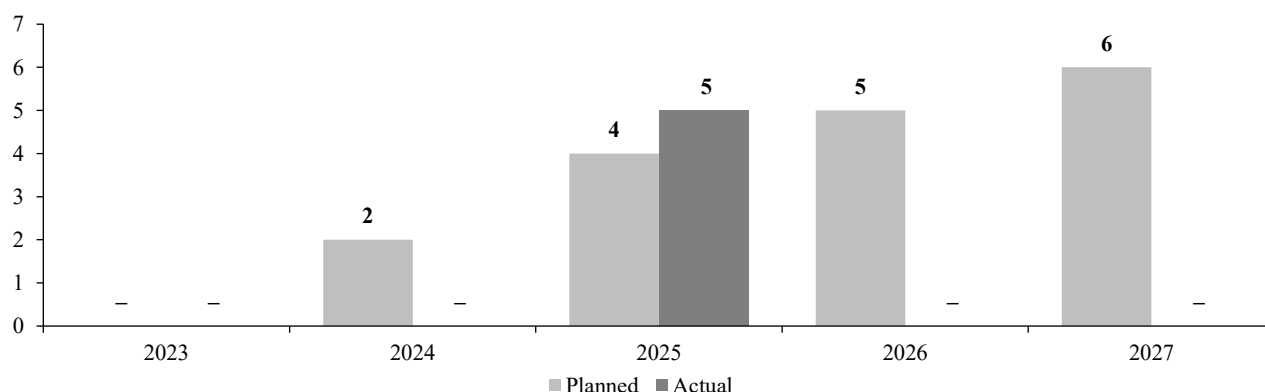
Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

18.182 The subprogramme's work contributed to five members of ECA (Ghana, Namibia, Senegal, United Republic of Tanzania and Zambia) assessing their social protection systems, which exceeded the planned target of four.

18.183 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 18.XXIV).

Figure 18.XXIV

Performance measure: number of members of ECA that have assessed their social protection systems (cumulative)



Result 2: strengthened national and regional reviews of population-related frameworks to promote sustainable development and leave no one behind

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

18.184 The subprogramme's work contributed to the preparation of voluntary national reviews on migration by 15 members of ECA, which met the planned target. Additionally, members of ECA accessed information for developing an action-oriented political document on social development for the Second World Social Summit for Social Development.

- 18.185 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.40).

Table 18.40

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
ECA members reviewed progress and identified gaps and challenges in the implementation of international population dynamics-related frameworks and adopted a common African position on population and development	Members of ECA adopted a common African agenda on the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration Outcomes of the Africa regional review of the International Conference on Population and Development informed discussions at the global 30-year Review of the Implementation of the Programme of Action of the Conference	Fifteen members of ECA prepared their voluntary national reviews on migration Members of ECA accessed information for developing an action-oriented political document on social development for the Second World Social Summit for Social Development	Members of ECA prepare an outcome document to share regional progress on the Global Compact for Safe, Orderly and Regular Migration at the 2026 International Migration Review Forum	Three members of ECA implement International Migration Review Forum recommendations

Result 3: strengthened evidence-based employment policies to harness Africa's demographic dividend
Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 18.186 Africa has the opportunity to benefit from a demographic dividend, but faces significant employment challenges due to skills mismatches, reliance on agriculture and rapid population growth. Millions enter the workforce each year, yet job creation does not keep pace, leading to employment in the informal sector and increased economic insecurity. To address these issues, the subprogramme has mapped national youth policies in ECA member States to develop or adapt their employment programmes with a view to improving livelihoods.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 18.187 The lesson for the subprogramme was the need for increased reliability and comparability of data related to employment challenges, to enable members of ECA to adapt to demographic changes, particularly the labour force bulge, and address the continent's unemployment challenges. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will facilitate the generation of knowledge and evidence on employment to inform employment policies and programmes by members of ECA and provide technical support for designing, implementing and evaluating employment initiatives. This will include strengthening capacity of policymakers and supporting data-driven adjustments to national strategies and programmes in response to demographic changes.
- 18.188 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 18.41).

Table 18.41
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
—	—	Members of ECA adopted a common African position on youth at the World Summit for Social Development	One member of ECA produces an evidence-based baseline report on employment	Two members of ECA implement recommendations from the baseline employment diagnosis

Deliverables

18.189 Table 18.42 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 18.42
Subprogramme 9: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	1	1	—	1
1. Report to the Committee on Social Policy, Poverty and Gender	1	1	—	1
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	4	4	—	4
2. Meetings of the Committee on Social Policy, Poverty and Gender	4	4	—	4
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	2	3	3	2
3. On social policy in Africa to enhance the capacities of policymakers in selected countries	1	2	2	1
4. Fellowship programme for young African scholars to build their capacity in poverty analysis, employment creation, social protection and migration	1	1	1	1
Seminars, workshops, and training events (number of days)	6	8	6	11
5. Workshops on social policies and policy dialogues for national policymakers in selected countries	6	8	6	11
Publications (number of publications)	3	2	1	2
6. African Social Development Report	1	1	—	1
7. Report on Social Policy in Africa	—	—	1	—
8. On social protection strategies in Africa	1	—	—	—
9. Africa Migration Report	1	1	—	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	2	2	3	5
10. On poverty and inequality	—	1	—	—
11. On social protection	1	1	1	1
12. On social development	—	—	1	—
13. On migration	1	—	1	1
14. On employment	—	—	—	3

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
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C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advice to national policymakers in seven selected members of ECA; advice for improved capacities in policy formulation, implementation, and monitoring; policy dialogues for enhanced policy learning and exchange at the national and regional levels.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: brochures pertinent to its workshops and training programmes in social policy, and development in two languages.

External and media relations: press and media releases on the role of cities and social policy in the development of Africa accessed by at least 250 experts.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: digital platform and visual materials on social protection and vulnerability, and social policy, among other issues.